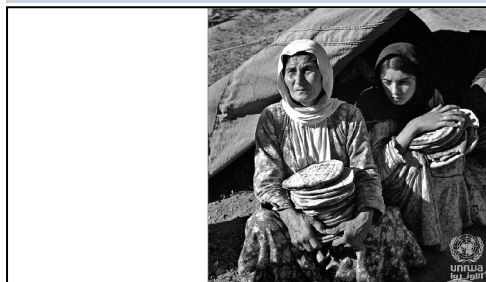


**OPTION P5: CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST, 1945–1995**

Complete Revision Guide • Core Knowledge, Cartographic Atlas &amp; Specification Volume

**36-PAGE MASTER EDITION****DUAL ARCHIVAL PLATES: TWO DEFINING TURNING POINTS OF MIDDLE EAST CONFLICT****1. THE 1948 AL-NAKBA (THE CATASTROPHE)**

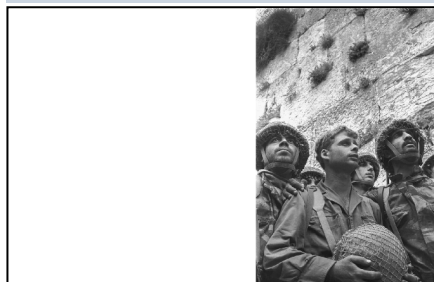
UNRWA Archive



**Significance:** Over 700,000 Palestinian Arabs displaced into permanent refugee exile following the 1948–49 War.

**2. 1967 PARATROOPERS AT WESTERN WALL**

Rubinger / GPO



**Significance:** Paratroopers secure East Jerusalem and Western Wall; 1 million Palestinians placed under military rule.

**OFFICIAL PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE SPECIFICATION AUDIT & REVISION CHECKLIST (OPTION P5)**

Tick each syllabus point once revised &amp; mastered:

**KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63****1. THE BRITISH WITHDRAWAL AND THE CREATION OF ISRAEL**

- ☐ Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- ☐ Key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- ☐ Key events of the Arab–Israeli war (1948–49).

**2. AFTERMATH OF THE 1948–49 WAR**

- ☐ Territorial changes and their impact.
- ☐ The refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- ☐ The creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950).
- ☐ US aid to Israel.
- ☐ Israel's relations with Egypt.

**3. INCREASED TENSION, 1955–63**

- ☐ Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- ☐ The events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- ☐ The events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

**KEY TOPIC 2: THE ESCALATING CONFLICT, 1964–73****1. THE SIX DAY WAR, 1967**

- ☐ The significance of the Cairo Conference (1964) and the growth of Fatah and the PLO.
- ☐ Escalating tension between Israel, Syria and Jordan: Syria's support for Fatah, Israel's raid on Samu and the events of 7 April 1967.
- ☐ The actions of the USSR, Nasser and the USA in the period leading to war.
- ☐ Key events of the war.

**2. AFTERMATH OF THE 1967 WAR**

- ☐ UN Resolution 242 and the continued dispute over the Suez Canal.
- ☐ Palestinian refugees and the significance of the occupied territories: Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank, Sinai and East Jerusalem.
- ☐ The use of terrorism, Israel's response and international attitudes towards the Palestine issue: the PFLP airplane hijacks of 1970; Black September and the Munich Olympics.
- ☐ The expulsion of the PLO from Jordan (1970).

**3. ISRAEL AND EGYPT, 1967–73**

- ☐ Egyptian relations with Israel, the USA, the USSR and other Arab states.
- ☐ Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories.
- ☐ Key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973) and its aftermath.

**KEY TOPIC 3: ATTEMPTS AT A SOLUTION, 1974–95****1. DIPLOMATIC NEGOTIATIONS**

- ☐ The significance of the oil crisis and the involvement of the USA and the USSR.
- ☐ Kissinger, 'shuttle diplomacy' and the reopening of the Suez Canal.
- ☐ Sadat's visit to Israel (1977), Begin's visit to Egypt (1977), US President Carter and Camp David (1978) and the Treaty of Washington (1979).

**2. THE PALESTINIAN ISSUE**

- ☐ Arafat's speech to the UN (1974).
- ☐ The significance of PLO activities in Lebanon.
- ☐ Israeli reprisals, the invasion of Lebanon (1982) and the results.
- ☐ The Israeli occupied territories and the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93).

**3. ATTEMPTS AT A SOLUTION**

- ☐ The significance of Arafat's renunciation of terrorism in a speech at the UN (1988).
- ☐ Changing superpower policies in the Middle East: US involvement in the Gulf War (1991), and the end of the Cold War.
- ☐ Arafat, Rabin and the Oslo Accords (1993); the setting up of the Palestinian National Authority; the Israel–Jordan peace treaty (1994); Oslo II (1995).

PAPER 2 BLUEPRINT: 50-MINUTE PACING & QUESTION ARCHITECTURE

EXAMINER METHOD

THE THREE QUESTION FORMATS • STRICT PACING GUIDE (32 MARKS TOTAL • 50 MINS)

Q1: EXPLAIN TWO CONSEQUENCES (8M • 12 MINS)

- **Structure:** Answer Question 1(a) [4 marks] AND Question 1(b) [4 marks] separately.
- **Formula:** State the consequence directly → Provide 2 precise supporting facts → Explain the causal outcome.
- **Pacing:** Spend strictly 6 minutes per consequence question (12 minutes total).

Q2: WRITE A NARRATIVE ACCOUNT (8M • 14 MINS)

- **Structure:** 3-stage chronological prose: Beginning → Turning Point → Outcome.
- **Formula:** Connect every paragraph with causal links (*Consequently, This led to*).
- **Rule:** You MUST go beyond the two stimulus points given on the exam paper.

Q3: EXPLAIN THE IMPORTANCE OF TWO EVENTS (16M • 24 MINS)

- **Choice:** Choose strictly **TWO out of three options** (3a, 3b, or 3c).
- **Paragraph 1:** Immediate short-term impact on the crisis or military situation.
- **Paragraph 2:** Long-term geopolitical consequence on peace or international relations.
- **Pacing:** 12 minutes per question (24 minutes total). Never answer all three!

FOUR NON-NEGOTIABLE EXAMINATION SUCCESS PRINCIPLES

- 1. **Precision Over Generic Recall:** Always cite exact dates, figures, and treaty clauses (e.g. *UN Res 242, 1979 Treaty of Washington*).
- 2. **Causal Linkages:** In Q2 narrative, never just list events; explain *how* event A forced event B to happen.
- 3. **Dual Significance in Q3:** Distinguish short-term military shock from long-term diplomatic realignment.
- 4. **Timing Discipline:** Leave 50 minutes for Paper 2 Period Study (do not steal time from British Depth study).

EXAMINER WARNING: THREE COMMON STUDENT PITFALLS

- **Confusing 1947 Partition with 1949 Armistice:** UN Res 181 was never implemented; the 1949 Green Line was created by combat.
- **Answering All Three in Q3:** Answering 3(a), 3(b), and 3(c) wastes 12 minutes and scores 0 extra marks.
- **Ignoring Superpower Context:** Forgetting the Cold War dimension (US vs Soviet arms supplies and diplomatic leverage).

50-YEAR SYNOPTIC TIMELINE: FROM STATEHOOD TO OSLO ACCORDS

SPECIFICATION  
ARC

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

**1945:** Jewish insurgency begins against White Paper quotas.  
**22 July 1946:** Irgun bombs King David Hotel (91 dead).  
**18 Feb 1947:** Britain surrenders Mandate to United Nations.  
**29 Nov 1947:** UN passes Resolution 181 partition plan (55% Jewish state).  
**14 May 1948:** Ben-Gurion declares State of Israel; 5 Arab armies invade.  
**1949:** Armistice agreements; Israel controls 79% (Green Line).  
**1950:** Knesset passes Law of Return; IDF formalized.  
**July 1956:** Nasser nationalises Suez Canal.  
**Oct–Nov 1956:** Suez Crisis; Israel storms Sinai; US forces withdrawal.

KEY TOPIC 2: THE ESCALATING CONFLICT, 1964–73

**1964:** Arab League establishes PLO at Cairo Summit.  
**May 1967:** Nasser expels UNEF and closes Straits of Tiran.  
**5–10 June 1967:** Six Day War; Israel captures Sinai, Gaza, West Bank, Golan.  
**Nov 1967:** UN passes Resolution 242 ('land for peace').  
**1969–70:** War of Attrition along Suez Canal.  
**Sept 1970:** Dawson's Field hijackings; Black September in Jordan.  
**Sept 1972:** Black September murders 11 Israeli athletes at Munich.  
**6–24 Oct 1973:** Yom Kippur War; Egyptian canal crossing; Sharon counter-attack.  
**1973:** OPEC oil embargo against Western nations.

KEY TOPIC 3: ATTEMPTS AT A SOLUTION, 1974–95

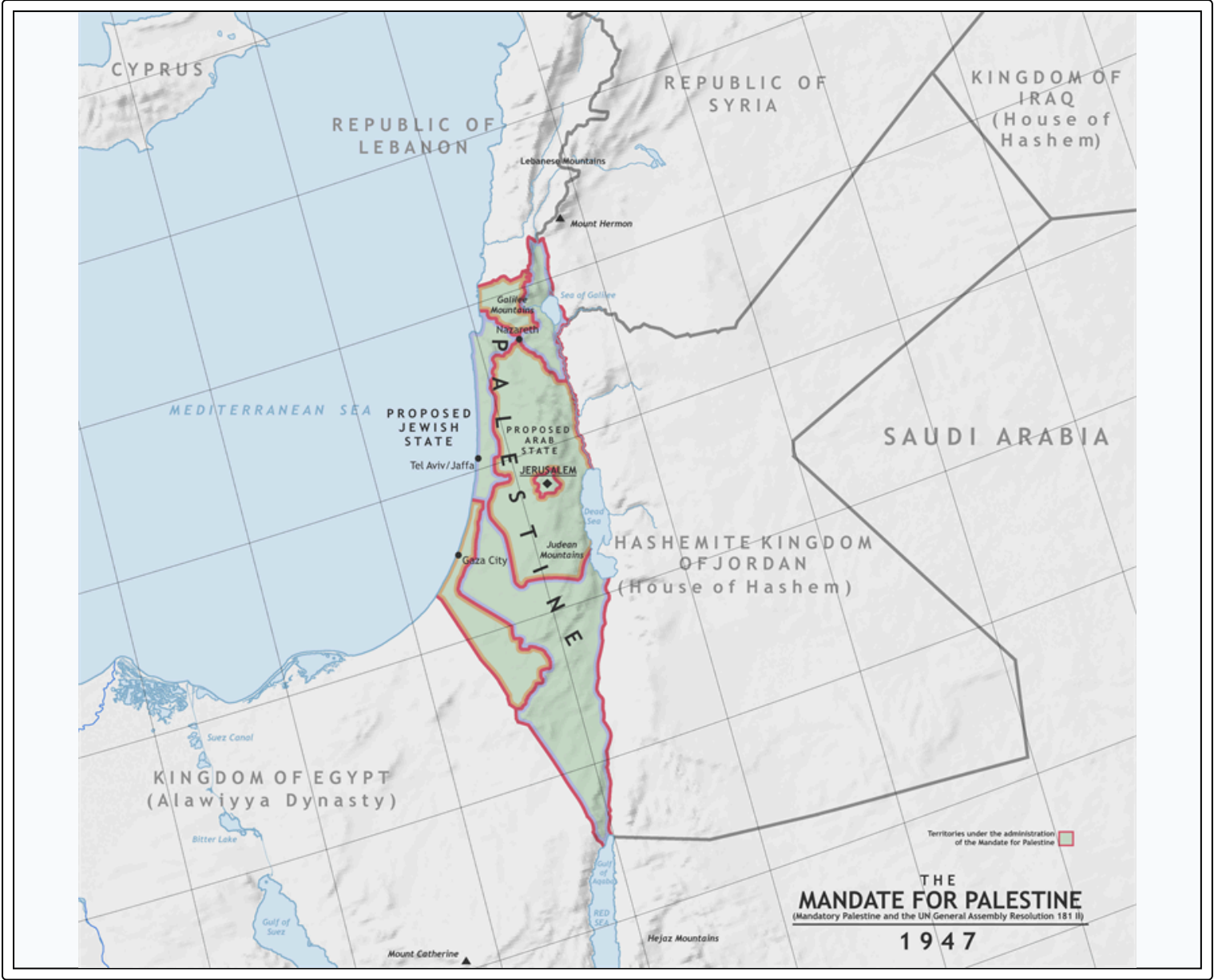
**1974–75:** Kissinger conducts shuttle diplomacy; Suez reopens.  
**Nov 1974:** Yasser Arafat addresses UN ('olive branch and gun').  
**Nov 1977:** Sadat historic visit to Jerusalem; addresses Knesset.  
**Sept 1978:** Carter brokers Camp David Accords.  
**26 Mar 1979:** Treaty of Washington (Egypt-Israel peace).  
**June 1982:** Israel invades Lebanon; Sabra and Shatila massacres.  
**Dec 1987:** First Palestinian Intifada erupts in Gaza and West Bank.  
**Nov 1988:** Arafat renounces terrorism; recognizes UN Res 242.  
**1993:** Oslo I Accord signed on White House lawn; PNA created.  
**1994:** Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty; 1995: Oslo II divides West Bank.

EXAMINER SYNOPTIC TAKEAWAY: THE MASTER ARC OF CONFLICT AND PEACE (1945–1995)

Notice the three major historical shifts across the 50-year period: (1) **From Imperial Dilemma to Statehood (1945–63):** Mandate collapse, the birth of Israel, and Nasser’s emergence as the Pan-Arab leader. (2) **From Conventional War to Asymmetric Insurgency (1964–73):** The 1967 victory brought 1 million Palestinians under military occupation, sparking armed fedayeen resistance and the 1973 Yom Kippur shock. (3) **From Bilateral Peace to Grassroots Stalemate (1974–95):** While Egypt and Jordan signed formal treaties, the Palestinian struggle moved from external bases to internal civil disobedience (the 1987 Intifada) and the fragile Oslo peace process.

THE 1947 UNITED NATIONS PARTITION PLAN  
(RESOLUTION 181)

FACING ATLAS SPREAD •  
LEFT



1. THE LAND & POPULATION ALLOCATION (UNSCOP)

- **Jewish State (55% of Land):** Allocated to ~500,000 Jews and ~400,000 Arabs. Included fertile coastal plain, Jezreel Valley, and Negev desert.
- **Arab State (45% of Land):** Allocated to ~725,000 Arabs and ~10,000 Jews. Included mountainous Judea, Samaria, and Western Galilee.
- **Jerusalem & Bethlehem:** Defined as an international *Corpus Separatum* under UN Trusteeship.

2. CONFLICTING STRATEGIC REACTIONS

- **Jewish Agency (David Ben-Gurion):** Accepted partition pragmatically as legal international recognition of Jewish sovereignty, despite fragmented borders.
- **Arab Higher Committee & Arab League:** Utterly rejected partition, refusing to surrender 55% of historic Palestine to a 33% minority without democratic consent.
- **Immediate Causal Impact:** Triggered civil war in Palestine (Nov 1947) and Arab invasion on 15 May 1948.

# THE 1948 ARAB INVASIONS & FIRST ARAB-ISRAELI WAR OPERATIONS

FACING ATLAS SPREAD • RIGHT



## 1. THE FIVE ARAB INVASIONS (15 MAY 1948)

- **Egyptian Army (11,000 men):** Advanced through Gaza strip along the coast towards Tel Aviv; halted at Isdud by Givati brigade and Czech-supplied Avia fighters.
- **Jordanian Arab Legion (5,000 men):** British-officered under Glubb Pasha; captured Old City of Jerusalem and severed the supply highway at Latrun.
- **Syrian, Lebanese & Iraqi Invasions:** Syrian armor thrust into Galilee (Degania); Iraqi troops occupied Jenin-Tulkarm triangle threatening coastal waist.

## 2. THE TURNING POINT & ISRAELI VICTORIES

- **UN 4-Week Truce (11 June):** Allowed Ben-Gurion to unify Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi into the IDF (Order No. 4) and import Czech aircraft and artillery.
- **Offensives (Oct-Dec 1948):** Operation Yoav secured the Negev; Operation Hiram cleared Upper Galilee; Arab armies lacked central command and coordination.
- **Strategic Outcome:** Israel expanded to 79% of mandatory Palestine; Green Line armistices signed in 1949 with zero formal peace treaties.

**Terror, Bankruptcy & Surrender: How Britain Lost Control of Palestine**

Following the Holocaust in Europe, Britain attempted to uphold the 1939 White Paper restriction of 15,000 Jewish refugees per year to secure Arab oil concessions and protect the Suez Canal. In response, Jewish underground paramilitary organisations—the official Haganah and militant splinter groups Irgun (led by Menachem Begin) and Lehi—launched a violent guerrilla insurgency against British military infrastructure. Exhausted by WWII debt, facing domestic outrage over soldier casualties, and pressured by US President Truman following the Anglo-American Committee (1946), Britain announced on 18 February 1947 that it would surrender the Mandate to the United Nations without recommending any solution.

1. Mandate Roots & Refugee Crisis

1923 TERMS & POST-WAR BLOCKADE

- 1923 Mandate Dilemma:** Following the 1917 Balfour Declaration, the League of Nations Mandate established 3 contradictory obligations: (1) protect civil and religious rights of the Arab majority, (2) establish a Jewish national home, and (3) prepare the country for independent self-government.
- Demographic Surge & 1936–39 Arab Revolt:** The Jewish population doubled by 1931 (from 84,000 to 175,000) and escalated rapidly as thousands fled Nazi Germany from 1933; Britain crushed the 1936–39 Arab Revolt with 20,000 troops and Haganah assistance, leaving Arab military leadership shattered.

2. Armed Insurgency & Sabotage

GUERRILLA STRIKES VS BRITISH RULE

- The Paramilitary Underground:** The mainstream Haganah (defense force led by Ben-Gurion) and militant splinter groups Irgun (led by Menachem Begin) and Lehi (Stern Gang) formed the unified Hebrew Resistance Movement following the furious August 1945 London Zionist conference.
- 153 Railway Bombs & Transport Paralysis:** Jewish underground fighters detonated **153 bombs on railway lines**, severed telephone communications, blew up military radar stations, and destroyed oil pipelines, effectively paralyzing British troop logistics across Palestine.

3. British Military Collapse

THE POLICE STATE & SURRENDER

- The "Bevingrad" Police State:** Britain deployed **100,000 soldiers** (1 soldier for every 6 Jews) costing **£40 million annually**; Jerusalem and Tel Aviv administration compounds were sealed behind massive barbed-wire fortresses nicknamed "Bevingrad" under strict curfews.
- Acre Prison Raid (May 1947):** Irgun commandos dynamited the ancient crusader fortress of Acre, freeing 27 underground prisoners; British military courts responded by sentencing 3 captured Irgun fighters to death by hanging.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                         | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ernest Bevin &amp; Attlee</b><br>British Foreign Secretary and Prime Minister who enforced immigration quotas to protect Arab oil alliances; surrendered Mandate to the UN in Feb 1947. | <b>David Ben-Gurion</b><br>Chairman of the Jewish Agency and leader of Haganah; coordinated political pressure and Aliyah Bet blockade running, but condemned King David Hotel bombing. | <b>Menachem Begin (Irgun)</b><br>Commander of militant Irgun; masterminded the King David Hotel bombing (91 dead), Acre Prison breakout, and the Sergeants Affair hanging in July 1947. | <b>Harry S. Truman</b><br>US President who demanded immediate entry for 100,000 Holocaust survivors and leveraged vital postwar American loans to force British withdrawal. |

PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • FOREIGN SECRETARY ERNEST BEVIN TO HOUSE OF COMMONS (18 FEB 1947):

Hansard Parliamentary Debates, Vol. 433, Col. 985

"His Majesty's Government have been faced with an irreconcilable conflict of principles... The Mandate is unworkable. We have decided to refer the whole problem to the United Nations without recommending any solution of our own."

**Historical Significance:** Demonstrates complete British admission of imperial failure; Britain refused to enforce partition and abandoned Palestine to civil war.

## KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

KT 1.1: The British Mandate, Jewish Underground & UN Referral (1945–47):  
Forensic Analysis & Word Bank

## 1. THE 1923 MANDATE DILEMMA &amp; PEEL COMMISSION

- **Contradictory Commitments:** Britain promised conflicting rights to both Arab majority and Jewish minority; by 1931, Jewish population had doubled to 175,000.
- **1936–39 Arab Revolt:** Crushed by 20,000 British troops aided by Haganah Special Night Squads (Orde Wingate), crippling Palestinian Arab political and military leadership.

## 2. RAILWAY SABOTAGE (153 BOMBS) &amp; KING DAVID HOTEL

- **London Conference Backlash (Aug 1945):** Fury at Attlee's Labour government upholding the White Paper led Jewish groups to launch an armed offensive against British rule.
- **Railway Sabotage:** Underground fighters set **153 bombs on railway lines**, blowing up tracks, locomotives, and signal boxes to paralyze British troop deployments.

## 3. SS EXODUS (4,500 SURVIVORS) &amp; US PRESSURE

- **Displaced Persons Crisis:** Over 250,000 Holocaust survivors remained languishing in European DP camps; Haganah's Aliyah Bet clandestine network purchased American ships to run blockades.
- **Blockade Running (July 1947):** The SS Exodus carried **4,500 Holocaust survivors**; Royal Navy destroyers rammed the vessel off Haifa, killing 3 and wounding dozens.

## 4. THE SERGEANTS AFFAIR &amp; THE BEVINGRAD POLICE STATE

- **"Bevingrad" Fortresses:** 100,000 British troops (£40m/yr cost) placed major cities under constant curfews, retreating into barbed-wire administrative compounds ("Bevingrad").
- **Acre Prison Raid (May 1947):** Irgun dynamited the ancient fortress of Acre, freeing 27 underground prisoners; Britain responded by sentencing 3 captured Irgun men to death.

## CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS

## 1. White Paper &amp; DP Camps

1939 cap (15k/yr) traps 250k Holocaust survivors in European camps; Aliyah Bet blockade running begins.

## 2. Insurgency &amp; 153 Bombs

Irgun & Haganah set 153 railway bombs; King David Hotel bombing kills 91; Bevin establishes police state.

## 3. Exodus &amp; Sergeants Affair

Exodus deportation shocks world; 2 sergeants hanged in retaliation; British public demands troop withdrawal.

## CAUSE &amp; CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

## 4. UN Referral (Feb 1947)

Exhausted by £40m annual costs, 100k troops, and US financial pressure, Britain surrenders Mandate to UN.

## ★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK &amp; ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS

## 12 KEY TERMS

**1923 MANDATE** League of Nations charter with conflicting obligations to Jews and Arabs.

**HAGANAH** Main Jewish paramilitary defense force led by David Ben-Gurion.

**KING DAVID HOTEL** British headquarters bombed by Irgun on 22 July 1946; 91 people killed.

**SERGEANTS AFFAIR** Hanging of two British sergeants by Irgun in retaliation for Acre executions.

**1939 WHITE PAPER** British policy limiting Jewish immigration to 15,000 per year for five years.

**IRGUN (ETZEL)** Militant revisionist splinter group led by Menachem Begin.

**SS EXODUS (1947)** Refugee ship carrying 4,500 Holocaust survivors forcibly returned to Germany.

**ERNEST BEVIN** British Foreign Secretary who referred Palestine to the UN on 18 Feb 1947.

**ALIYAH BET** Clandestine Jewish underground network organizing illegal refugee ships.

**153 RAILWAY BOMBS** Sabotage strikes on railway lines crippling British transport.

**BEVINGRAD** Fortified, barbed-wire security compounds housing British personnel.

**HARRY S. TRUMAN** US President who demanded entry for 100,000 refugees, pressuring Britain.

Resolution 181 to Armistice: How the Infant State of Israel Survived

On 29 November 1947, the UN General Assembly voted to partition Palestine into independent Arab and Jewish states, with Jerusalem under international control (Corpus Separatum). Arabs rejected the plan as unjust because Arabs comprised 67% of the population but were allocated under 44% of the land, while the proposed Jewish state contained 400,000 Arab residents. The vote triggered an immediate civil war, marked by the Deir Yassin massacre (around 100 killed), causing 250,000 Palestinians to flee before 15 May 1948. When David Ben-Gurion declared the State of Israel on 14 May 1948, five Arab armies invaded. Despite 650,000 Israelis facing 40 million Arabs, Israel secured survival through the June truce, Czech arms airlifts, and unified IDF military leadership.

1. UN Resolution 181 (Nov 1947)
- THE DEMOGRAPHIC PARTITION DILEMMA
- The Partition Vote (29 Nov 1947):** UNSCOP toured Palestine in summer 1947 (boycotted by Arab Higher Committee); the UN voted 33 to 13 (with 10 abstentions, both US and USSR voting YES) to partition Palestine into separate states.
  - The Demographic Imbalance:** Arabs formed **67% (two-thirds) of the population** and owned most cultivated land, but received under **44% of the land**; the proposed Jewish state received **55% of the land** (mostly Negev Desert).

2. Civil War & Deir Yassin Panic
- DECEMBER 1947 – MAY 1948
- Outbreak of Civil War:** Violence erupted immediately after the UN vote; Arab irregulars ambushed Jewish convoys, blockading food and water supplies to **100,000 Jewish residents besieged in Jerusalem**.
  - Arab Liberation Army (ALA):** The Arab League sponsored 5,000 volunteers under Fawzi al-Qawuqji crossing into Palestine before British withdrawal, surrounding Jewish enclaves in Galilee and the Negev.

3. The Five-Army Invasion & Victory
- 15 MAY 1948 – JULY 1949
- Declaration & Invasion:** On 14 May 1948, Ben-Gurion proclaimed Israeli independence (instantly recognized by US and USSR); on 15 May, regular armies of Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Iraq, and Lebanon invaded: **650,000 Israelis faced 40 million Arabs**.
  - Unified Command (28 May 1948):** Ben-Gurion established the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF), absorbing Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi into a single staff; Arab armies were deeply divided with conflicting territorial ambitions.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                   | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>David Ben-Gurion</div> <div>Read the Israeli Declaration of Independence on 14 May 1948; created the unified IDF on 28 May and directed overall war strategy.</div> | <div>King Abdullah I of Transjordan</div> <div>Commander of the British-trained Arab Legion; captured the Old City of Jerusalem and annexed the West Bank, clashing with other Arab states.</div> | <div>Count Folke Bernadotte</div> <div>UN Special Mediator who brokered the decisive June 1948 Truce; assassinated in Jerusalem by the militant Jewish group Lehi in Sept 1948.</div> | <div>Fawzi al-Qawuqji</div> <div>Field Commander of the Arab League's volunteer Arab Liberation Army (ALA), which entered Palestine to fight Jewish forces prior to 15 May.</div> |

PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • DAVID BEN-GURION DECLARING THE STATE OF ISRAEL (14 MAY 1948):

Tel Aviv Museum of Art, Official Declaration Transcript

"We hereby declare the establishment of a Jewish State in the Land of Israel, to be known as the State of Israel... We appeal to the Arab inhabitants of the State of Israel to preserve peace and participate in the upbuilding of the State on the basis of full and equal citizenship."

**Historical Significance:** Proclaimed sovereign Jewish statehood for the first time in 2,000 years, triggering the immediate entry of five regular Arab armies.

## KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

## KT 1.2: UN Partition Resolution 181 &amp; The 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War: Forensic Analysis &amp; Word Bank

**1. THE RES 181 DEMOGRAPHIC REALITY & ALA INCURSION**

- **Demographic Imbalance:** Arabs held a 2:1 population majority (**67% vs 33%**) but received only 43% of land, while the Jewish state included **400,000 Arab Palestinians** within its designated borders.
- **Economic Union Failure:** UN envisioned shared currency and ports; Arab Higher Committee declared a 3-day general strike and vowed partition would be drowned in blood.

**2. DEIR YASSIN (100 DEAD) & THE 250,000 REFUGEE WAVE**

- **Jerusalem Blockade:** Arab forces cut off the supply road to 100,000 Jewish residents in Jerusalem, causing severe starvation and water rationing.
- **The Deir Yassin Attack (9 April):** Irgun and Lehi fighters stormed the strategic hillside village; house-to-house fighting and grenade clearing resulted in **around 100 villagers killed**.

**3. THE FIRST UN TRUCE & THE CZECH ARMS LIFELINE**

- **Existential Threat (May 1948):** In the first three weeks, Syrian tanks pushed into Galilee and Egyptian columns reached Ashdod, just 32km south of Tel Aviv.
- **The June Truce (11 June – 8 July):** Four-week ceasefire mediated by Count Bernadotte allowed Israel to import 25,000 rifles, 5,000 machine guns, and 25 Avia S-199 fighters from communist Czechoslovakia.

**4. DIVIDED ARAB ARMIES VS UNIFIED IDF STRUCTURE**

- **650,000 vs 40 Million:** While Arab nations possessed massive demographic superiority, their invading expeditionary forces totaled only 40,000 troops vs 35,000 initial Israeli fighters.
- **Inter-Arab Rivalry:** King Abdullah of Transjordan refused to advance beyond the West Bank, having reached an informal understanding with the Jewish Agency, which angered Egypt and Syria.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS****CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN****1. Res 181 Partition (Nov 47)**

UN votes 33-13 to partition Palestine; Arabs reject giving 55% land to 33% population with 400k Arabs in Jewish zone.

**2. Deir Yassin & Flight (Apr 48)**

Irgun/Lehi attack Deir Yassin killing ~100; Arab broadcast panic triggers mass flight of 250k Palestinians before 15 May.

**3. June Truce & Czech Arms**

Bernadotte brokers 4-week truce; IDF imports Czech Avia fighters and rifles, and carves Burma Road into Jerusalem.

**4. Operation Yoav & Armistices**

100k IDF troops rout divided Arab armies; 1949 Rhodes armistices give Israel 79% of land; Iraq refuses to sign.

## ★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK &amp; ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS

## 12 KEY TERMS

**UN RESOLUTION 181** Nov 1947 UN plan to partition Palestine into Arab and Jewish states with international Jerusalem.

**PLAN DALET (PLAN D)** Haganah operational strategy in April 1948 to secure borders and communication routes.

**IDF (28 MAY 1948)** Unified national military created by Ben-Gurion, dissolving independent underground militias.

**BURMA ROAD** Makeshift mountain bypass road carved by Israeli engineers to break the Arab siege of Jerusalem.

**CORPUS SEPARATUM** Special international legal status designated for Jerusalem and Bethlehem under UN control.

**DEIR YASSIN** Arab village near Jerusalem attacked on 9 April 1948; ~100 civilians killed, sparking mass panic.

**FIRST UN TRUCE** Four-week ceasefire (11 June – 8 July 1948) mediated by Bernadotte, exploited by IDF to rearm.

**COUNT BERNADOTTE** UN mediator who negotiated the first truce; assassinated in Jerusalem by Lehi in Sept 1948.

**ARAB LIBERATION ARMY** Volunteer force of 5,000 Arab fighters under Fawzi al-Qawuqji entering Palestine in Jan 1948.

**650K VS 40 MILLION** Demographic ratio of the new State of Israel versus surrounding hostile Arab nations in May 1948.

**CZECH ARMS DEAL** Crucial communist arms shipment of 25k rifles, machine guns, and Avia S-199 fighters to Israel.

**RHODES ARMISTICES** 1949 bilateral ceasefires between Israel and Egypt, Lebanon, Jordan, and Syria; Iraq refused.

**The Catastrophe & The Sanctuary: Two Incompatible Post-War Realities**

The 1948–49 War transformed Middle Eastern demographics. For Palestinians, the war was Al-Nakba ("The Catastrophe"): over 700,000 Arabs were displaced from their homes, leaving only 160,000 within Israeli borders, while over 400 Arab villages were depopulated. The 1949 Rhodes Armistices established the Green Line, expanding Israeli territory to 79% of mandatory Palestine. Transjordan annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem, while Egypt occupied Gaza. For Israelis, 1948 was the "Year of Liberation", but the new state faced severe economic crises and hostile borders. Israel instituted mandatory IDF conscription (1949), passed the Law of Return (July 1950) doubling its population through 685,000 immigrants (including 300,000 from Arab lands), and survived through severe austerity (Tzema) and \$300m in US grants.

1. Al-Nakba: The Catastrophe (1948–49)

THE PALESTINIAN REFUGEE TRAGEDY

- The Scale of Displacement:** Over **700,000 to 750,000 Palestinian Arabs** became refugees; only **160,000 Palestinians out of 900,000** remained in Israeli territory; over 400 Arab villages were depopulated, dismantled, or resettled.
- Exact 1949 Settlement Breakdown:** Pearson records the exact 1949 refugee distribution: **280,000 in the West Bank (Jordan)**, **190,000 in the Gaza Strip (Egypt)**, **100,000 in Lebanon**, **75,000 in Syria**, **70,000 in Transjordan**, **4,000 in Iraq**, **7,000 in Egypt**, and **48,000 internally displaced**.

2. 1949 Rhodes Armistices & Borders

THE GREEN LINE & TERRITORIAL SHIFTS

- Bilateral Rhodes Armistices:** Mediated by UN diplomat Ralph Bunche; the armistice agreements established armistice demarcation lines (the "Green Line") rather than recognized permanent political borders.
- 79% Green Line Control:** Israel expanded its territory from 55% under UN Res 181 to **79% of mandatory Palestine** (a 50% land gain), conquering fertile Galilee, the central coastal corridor, and the Negev down to Eilat.

3. Israeli Nation-Building & Survival

CONSCRIPTION, MA'ABAROT & US AID

- Universal IDF Conscription (1949):** The 1949 Defence Service Law made military service compulsory at 18: **30 months for males, 18 months for females**, followed by mandatory annual reserve duty of 1 month per year up to age **55**.
- Law of Return & Demographics (July 1950):** Granted every Jew worldwide the right to settle in Israel and gain citizenship; Israel absorbed **618,500 Jewish refugees from Arab and Muslim countries** (Iraq, Yemen, Morocco, Egypt) by 1972, doubling the population.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                             | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Ralph Bunche</b><br/>US diplomat and UN Mediator who negotiated the 1949 Rhodes Armistice Agreements, earning the 1950 Nobel Peace Prize.</div> | <div><b>David Ben-Gurion</b><br/>Israeli Prime Minister who passed the Law of Return (1950), built the IDF conscription model, and barred Palestinian refugee return.</div> | <div><b>King Abdullah I</b><br/>Ruler of Jordan who formally annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem in 1950, granting citizenship to 280,000 Palestinian refugees.</div> | <div><b>Ariel Sharon</b><br/>Young IDF officer appointed in 1953 to command Unit 101, conducting aggressive retaliatory raids against Fedayeen bases.</div> |

**PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • UN GENERAL ASSEMBLY RESOLUTION 194, ARTICLE 11****United Nations Official Records, Third Session**  
**(11 DEC 1948):**

*"Resolves that the refugees wishing to return to their homes and live at peace with their neighbours should be permitted to do so at the earliest practicable date, and that compensation should be paid for the property of those choosing not to return..."*

**Historical Significance:** Became the international legal bedrock of the Palestinian "Right of Return", rejected by Israel on national security and demographic grounds.

**KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63**
**KT 1.3: Aftermath of 1948–49: Al-Nakba & Israeli State Consolidation: Forensic Analysis & Word Bank**
**1. THE 1949 REFUGEE SETTLEMENT DISTRIBUTION**

- **Displacement Figures:** 700k–750k Palestinians displaced; exact 1949 spread: **280k in West Bank, 190k in Gaza, 100k in Lebanon, 75k in Syria, 70k in Jordan.**
- **UNRWA Mandate (Dec 1949):** United Nations Relief and Works Agency took over 59 camps; refugees lived in canvas tents with open sewers and high infant mortality.

**2. THE RHODES ARMISTICES & THE 79% GREEN LINE**

- **Green Line Borders:** The 1949 armistice lines drawn in green grease pencil on maps in Rhodes; never recognized by Arab states as permanent international borders.
- **21% Land Gain:** Israel gained Galilee, the coastal plain, and the Negev corridor down to Eilat on the Gulf of Aqaba, securing vital agricultural and maritime depth.

**3. IDF CONSCRIPTION & THE "CITIZEN ARMY"**

- **Universal Conscription (1949):** At 18, **men served 30 months, women served 18 months**, with mandatory annual reserve service up to age **55**.
- **Strategic Imperative:** Surrounded by 40 million hostile neighbors, Israel could not maintain a massive standing army; conscription turned society into a mobile reserve force in 48 hours.

**4. ECONOMIC AUSTERITY, MA'ABAROT & \$300M US AID**

- **Population Doubled (1948–51):** 685,000 immigrants arrived, including 300,000 Holocaust survivors and 300,000 Sephardic/Mizrahi Jews fleeing Arab states.
- **Tzena (Austerity):** Severe food rationing; points books required for meat, eggs, and bread; widespread public unrest over harsh living standards.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS**
**CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN**
**1. War Flight & Expulsions**

700k Palestinians displaced; 280k flee to West Bank, 190k to Gaza, 100k to Lebanon, 75k to Syria, 70k to Jordan.

**2. Rhodes Armistice (1949)**

Green Line established; Israel controls 79% of land; Jordan annexes West Bank; only 160k Arabs remain in Israel.

**3. Law of Return & Conscription**

July 1950 Law of Return doubles population; IDF institutes 30m men / 18m women conscription to age 55.

**4. Ma'abarot & US Aid**

200k immigrants housed in transit tent camps; \$300m US aid and German reparations prevent economic collapse.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS**
**12 KEY TERMS**

**AL-NAKBA (1948)** The "Catastrophe": the flight and expulsion of 700,000 Palestinian Arabs from their homes.

**GREEN LINE** 1949 Rhodes Armistice line defining borders until 1967; Israel controlled 79% of land.

**LAW OF RETURN (1950)** Legislation granting every Jewish person worldwide the right to settle in Israel.

**MA'ABAROT** Makeshift transit camps of canvas tents and tin shacks housing 200,000 new immigrants.

**1949 DISTRIBUTION** Refugees in West Bank (280k), Gaza (190k), Lebanon (100k), Syria (75k), Jordan (70k).

**UN RESOLUTION 194** UN resolution affirming Palestinian Right of Return or financial compensation.

**IDF CONSCRIPTION (1949)** Mandatory military service at 18: 30 months for men, 18 for women, reserves to 55.

**\$300M US AID** Vital US government loans and grants that funded Israeli infrastructure and immigrant absorption.

**UNRWA (DEC 1949)** UN agency created to provide food, medical aid, and schooling across 59 refugee camps.

**ABSENTEE PROPERTY LAW** 1950 Israeli law confiscating land and property left behind by fleeing refugees.

**TZENA (AUSTERITY)** Strict economic rationing of food, clothing, and furniture in Israel from 1949 to 1953.

**RALPH BUNCHE** UN mediator who negotiated the 1949 armistices on Rhodes; won Nobel Peace Prize.

**Nationalisation, Collusion & Humiliation: The 1956 Suez Crisis**

The overthrow of Egypt's monarchy in 1952 brought Colonel Gamal Abdel Nasser to power, championing pan-Arab nationalism and the end of British imperial influence. After negotiating the withdrawal of 80,000 British soldiers from the Suez Canal Zone, Nasser faced escalating border clashes in Gaza. Following a February 1955 Israeli raid that killed 38 Egyptian soldiers, Nasser signed the September 1955 Czech Arms Deal and blockaded the Gulf of Aqaba. When the US and Britain cancelled financing for the Aswan High Dam, Nasser nationalised the Suez Canal on 26 July 1956. Britain and France colluded with Israel in the secret Protocol of Sèvres (22 October 1956). Israel invaded Sinai on 29 October, followed by Anglo-French paratrooper landings at Port Said. However, a US financial ultimatum forced a humiliating British and French withdrawal on 23 November 1956, cementing Nasser as the undisputed hero of the Arab world and establishing the United Arab Republic (UAR) with Syria in 1958.

- 1. Nasser's Revolution & Gaza Raids**
- THE CYCLE OF ESCALATION (1954–55)
- **British Troop Withdrawal (1954):** Nasser negotiated the departure of **80,000 British troops** stationed in the Suez Canal Zone, removing imperial control; he instituted land redistribution and free public hospitals.
  - **Aswan High Dam Ambition:** Nasser planned a monumental dam at Aswan to control annual Nile floods, generate hydro-electricity for industrialization, and irrigate thousands of hectares of fertile farmland.

- 2. Nationalisation & Sèvres Collusion**
- THE SECRET WAR PLAN (1956)
- **Aswan Dam & Nationalisation:** In April 1956, 58 civilians died in mortar attacks; in July 1956, the US and UK abruptly cancelled \$70m in Aswan Dam funding; Nasser nationalised the Suez Canal on **26 July 1956** to fund the dam from tolls.
  - **Protocol of Sèvres (22 Oct 1956):** Secret meeting outside Paris between Ben-Gurion, Selwyn Lloyd (UK), and Guy Mollet (France): Israel would invade Sinai; Britain and France would intervene as "peacekeepers" and re-seize the canal.

- 3. Superpowers & Strategic Fall-out**
- US ULTIMATUM & UNEF ARRIVAL
- **US Economic Ultimatum:** President Eisenhower was furious at Anglo-French deceit during the US election; the US threatened to collapse the British pound, block IMF emergency loans, and embargo oil shipments.
  - **Soviet Nuclear Threats & UN Ceasefire:** Premier Bulganin threatened rocket attacks on London and Paris; on 6 Nov 1956, Britain and France accepted a UN ceasefire, suffering total imperial humiliation.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                    | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Gamal Abdel Nasser</b></div> <div>Egyptian President who nationalised the Suez Canal on 26 July 1956 and emerged as the hero of pan-Arab nationalism despite military defeat.</div> | <div><b>Anthony Eden</b></div> <div>British Prime Minister who viewed Nasser as a dangerous dictator ("Hitler on the Nile"); resigned in health and political disgrace following the crisis.</div> | <div><b>David Ben-Gurion</b></div> <div>Israeli Prime Minister who signed the secret Protocol of Sèvres to break the Straits of Tiran blockade and crush Egyptian Fedayeen bases in Gaza.</div> | <div><b>Dwight D. Eisenhower</b></div> <div>US President who halted the Anglo-French-Israeli invasion through devastating financial and economic threats against the British pound.</div> |

**PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • GAMAL ABDEL NASSER NATIONALISING THE SUEZ CANAL IN ALEXANDRIA (26 JULY 1956):**

Egyptian State Radio Broadcast Recording

*"The Suez Canal was dug with the lives of 120,000 Egyptian sons who died in its construction... Today, we take back our rights. We are nationalising the Suez Canal Company. The canal belongs to Egypt, and we shall build the High Dam with its revenues!"*

**Historical Significance:** Direct defiance of 80 years of Anglo-French imperial domination, triggering the secret military collusion that destroyed Britain as an independent global superpower.

**KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63**
**KT 1.4: Nasser, Pan-Arabism & The Suez Crisis (1956–63): Forensic Analysis & Word Bank**
**1. NASSER'S PAN-ARABISM & THE 80,000 TROOPS EXIT**

- **1952 Free Officers Revolution:** General Naguib and Colonel Nasser overthrew the corrupt British-backed King Farouk, seeking total national sovereignty and social land reform.
- **British Canal Evacuation (1954):** Nasser pressured Britain into agreeing to withdraw its **80,000 soldiers stationed along the Suez Canal Zone** within 20 months.

**2. THE GAZA REPRISAL CYCLE & CZECH ARMS (1955)**

- **Fedayeen Infiltrations:** Palestinian guerrillas operating from Egyptian-administered Gaza staged cross-border sabotage raids into southern Israeli farms.
- **The Gaza Raid (Feb 1955):** IDF commandos under Ariel Sharon killed **38 Egyptian soldiers** in Gaza; in Aug 1955, Fedayeen killed 11 Israelis, prompting an IDF raid killing **72 Egyptians**.

**3. THE PROTOCOL OF SÈVRES & THE TRIPARTITE INVASION**

- **Western Loan Withdrawal (July 1956):** US and Britain cancelled Aswan Dam loans; Nasser nationalised the Suez Canal on **26 July 1956** in retaliation.
- **Sèvres Conspiracy (22–24 Oct):** Britain, France, and Israel secretly signed the Protocol of Sèvres in a Parisian villa, choreographing a false-flag war.

**4. US FINANCIAL COERCION, UNEF & THE TRIUMPH OF NASSER**

- **Eisenhower's Ultimatum:** US threatened to crash the British pound and withhold emergency oil supplies unless Britain ordered an immediate ceasefire.
- **UNEF Peacekeeping Force:** First-ever UN peacekeeping force deployed to Sinai on **21 Nov 1956**; British and French forces withdrew in humiliation on **23 Nov 1956**.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS**
**CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN**
**1. Gaza Raids & Czech Arms**

Feb 1955 Gaza raid (38 dead) prompts Nasser to sign Czech Arms Deal (\$250m) and close Straits of Tiran.

**2. Nationalisation (26 July 56)**

US/UK cancel Aswan Dam loan; Nasser nationalises Suez Canal to fund the dam from canal transit tolls.

**3. Protocol of Sèvres & Attack**

Secret collusion at Sèvres; IDF invades Sinai 29 Oct; UK/France bomb airfields and land paratroopers at Port Said.

**4. US Ultimatum & UAR (1958)**

Eisenhower threatens pound collapse; allies withdraw; Nasser hailed as Arab hero; UAR formed with Syria in 1958.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS**
**12 KEY TERMS**

**GAMAL ABDEL NASSER** Charismatic Egyptian President (1954–70), champion of pan-Arabism and national sovereignty.

**CZECH ARMS DEAL (1955)** \$250m deal for 200 Soviet MiG-15 jets and 300 tanks, breaking Western arms dominance.

**PROTOCOL OF SÈVRES** Secret tripartite war agreement signed on 22 Oct 1956 between Britain, France, and Israel.

**US FINANCIAL THREAT** Eisenhower's threat to collapse sterling, forcing an immediate British ceasefire.

**80,000 BRITISH TROOPS** British military garrison occupying the Suez Canal Zone, evacuated in 1954 under treaty.

**ASWAN HIGH DAM** Monumental Egyptian infrastructure project to harness the Nile, initially denied Western loans.

**OPERATION KADESH** Israeli invasion of Sinai on 29 Oct 1956, reaching the Suez Canal in under 48 hours.

**UNEF (NOV 1956)** First UN Emergency Force deployed to police Sinai and guarantee Israeli shipping at Tiran.

**GAZA RAID (FEB 1955)** IDF retaliatory raid killing 38 Egyptian soldiers, triggering Nasser's rearmament drive.

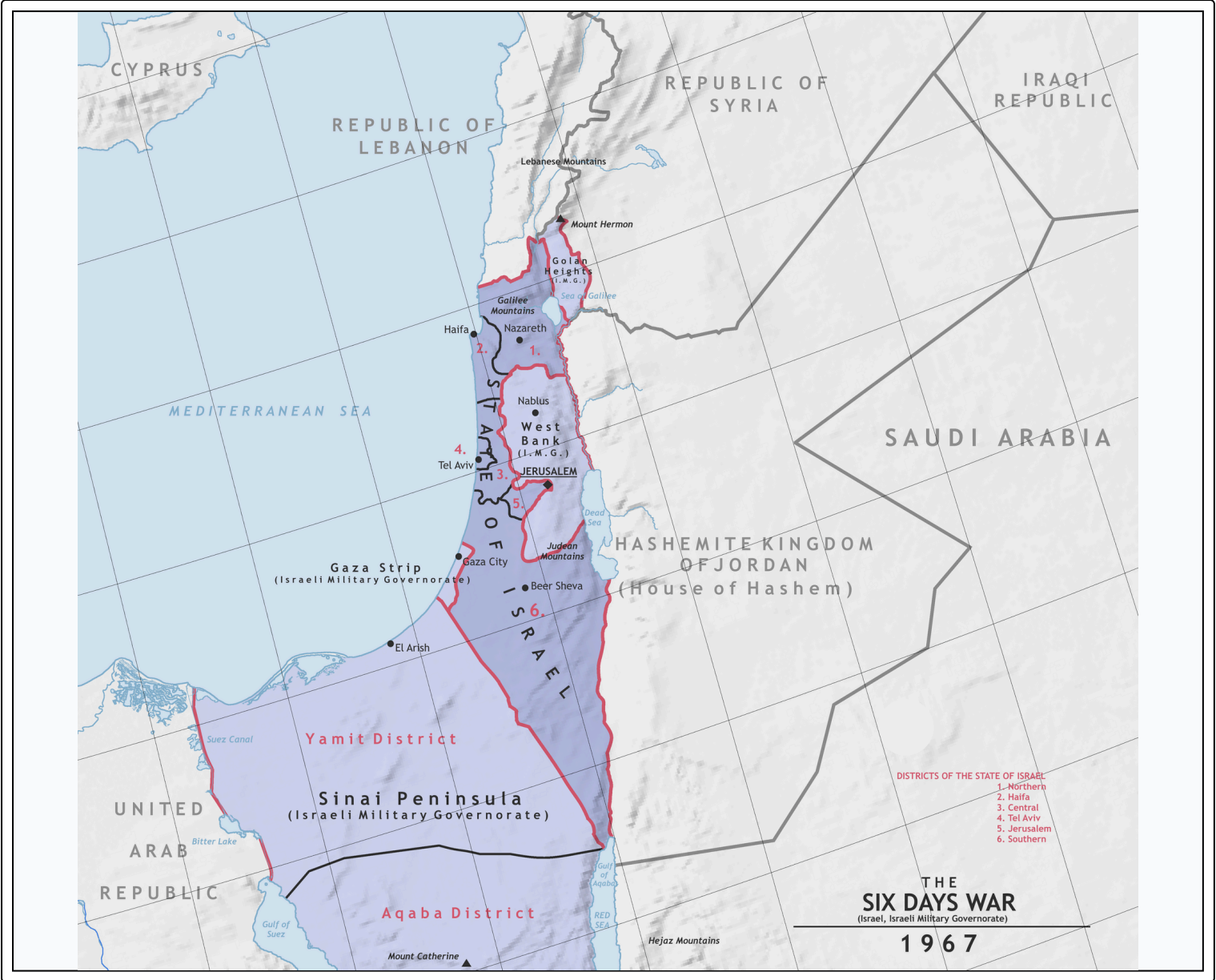
**NATIONALISATION (1956)** Nasser seized control of the Suez Canal Company on 26 July 1956 to fund the Aswan Dam.

**PORT SAID LANDINGS** Anglo-French airborne and amphibious assault on 5 Nov 1956 to seize the Suez Canal.

**UAR (1958–61)** United Arab Republic: political union between Egypt and Syria reflecting Nasser's prestige.

THE 1967 SIX DAY WAR & THE FIVE OCCUPIED TERRITORIES

FACING ATLAS SPREAD • LEFT



1. THE THREE FRONTS OF BLITZKRIEG (5–10 JUNE 1967)

- **Pre-emptive Air Strike (Operation Focus):** Destroyed 300+ Egyptian aircraft on runways in 3 hours; gained total air supremacy.
- **Sinai Front (Tal, Yoffe, Sharon):** Smashed Egyptian defences at Abu Ageila; reached Suez Canal in 4 days, capturing 60,000 km<sup>2</sup> Sinai.
- **Central & Northern Fronts:** Paratroopers took Old City Jerusalem & West Bank (7 June); stormed Golan escarpment (9–10 June).

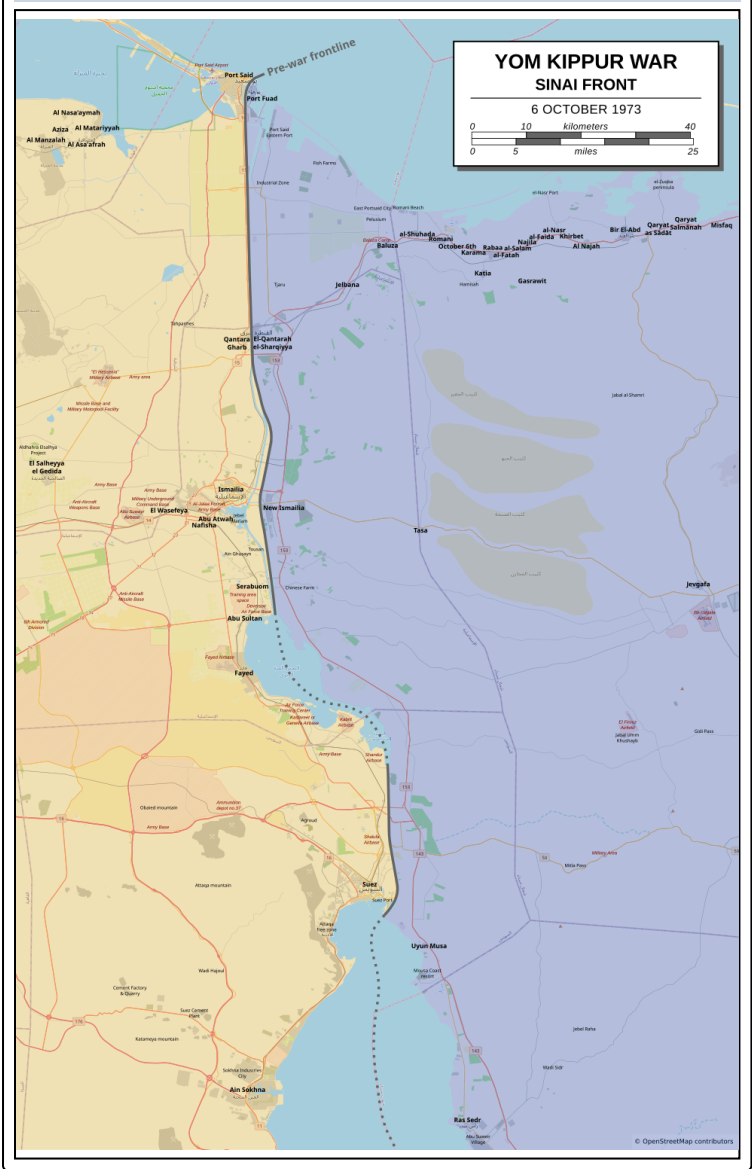
2. DIPLOMATIC & DEMOGRAPHIC CONSEQUENCES

- **Territorial Quadrupling:** Israel controlled Sinai Peninsula, Gaza Strip, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and Syrian Golan Heights.
- **UN Resolution 242 (Nov 1967):** "Land for Peace" formula established; withdrawal from territories in exchange for Arab recognition.
- **Khartoum Summit (Sept 1967):** Arab League declared "Three No's": No peace, No recognition, No negotiations with Israel.

THE 1973 YOM KIPPUR WAR: SINAI & GOLAN HEIGHTS CAMPAIGNS

FACING ATLAS SPREAD • RIGHT

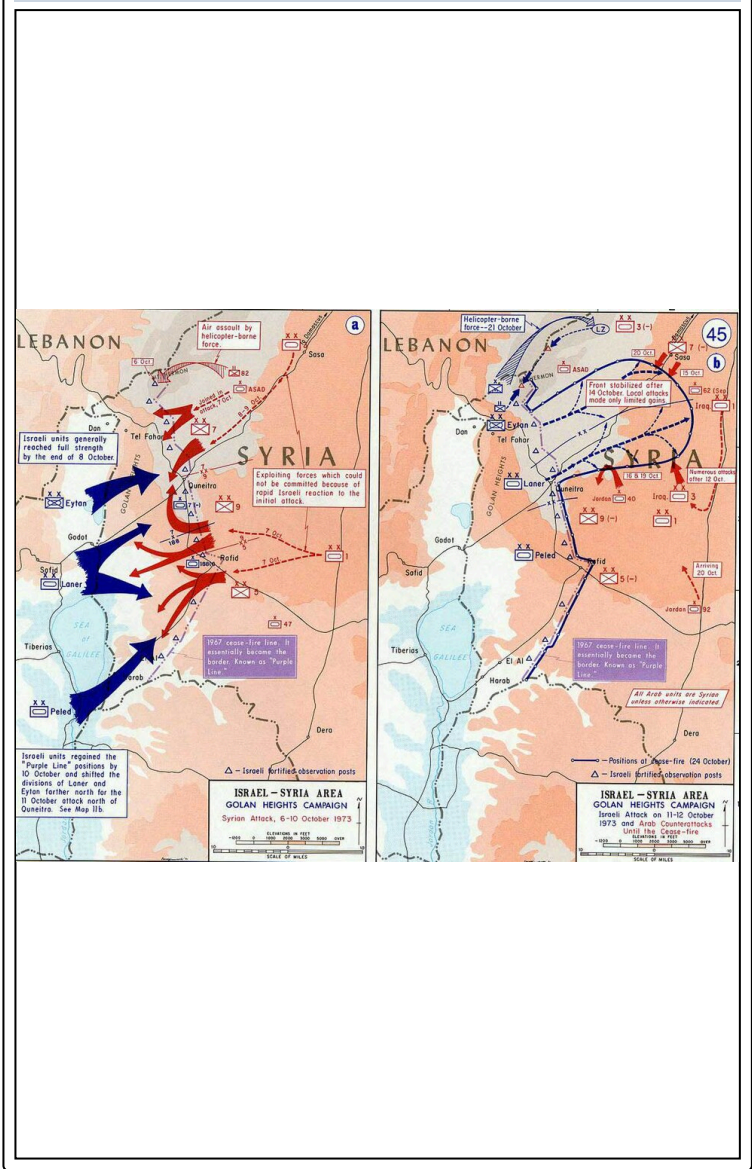
FRONT 1: THE SUEZ CANAL & SINAI CROSSING



1. SINAI FRONT: OPERATION BADR (6 OCT 1973)

- **The Water-Cannon Breach:** 80,000 Egyptian troops breached the 20m high Bar-Lev sand rampart with high-pressure water hoses in hours.
- **The SAM Umbrella:** Soviet SAM-6 missiles neutralized the Israeli Air Force; Sagger anti-tank missiles decimated Israeli counter-attacks.
- **Sharon's Crossing:** IDF crossed canal at Deversoir (15 Oct), encircled Egyptian Third Army, threatening Cairo.

FRONT 2: THE GOLAN HEIGHTS CAMPAIGN



2. GOLAN FRONT: BATTLE OF THE VALLEY OF TEARS

- **Syrian Surprise Attack:** 1,400 Syrian tanks stormed the Purple Line; Israeli 7th & 188th Brigades fought desperate defensive stand.
- **IDF Counter-Offensive:** Israeli reserves pushed Syrians back across the Purple Line, advancing within 35 km of Damascus.
- **Global Ramifications:** Triggered US-Soviet nuclear DEFCON 3 standoff, OPEC oil embargo, and paved way for Camp David diplomacy.

**Brinkmanship, Air Blitz & Quadrupled Land: The Six Day War**

Between 1964 and 1967, regional flashpoints escalated rapidly. The January 1964 Cairo Conference established the PLO and the Palestine Liberation Army (PLA, 12,000 fighters), alongside the Arab Headwater Diversion Plan targeting the Jordan River headwaters. Over 70 Fatah raids led to Israeli reprisal strikes, notably the massive Samu Raid on 13 November 1966 (600 troops, 11 tanks, 60 vehicles) and the 7 April 1967 air clash downing 6 Syrian MiGs over Damascus. On 13 May 1967, false Soviet intelligence claimed Israel was massing troops on Syria's border, prompting Nasser to expel UNEF, mobilize 100,000 troops, and close the Straits of Tiran, issuing ultimatums on 29 May. On 5 June 1967, Israel launched Operation Focus, destroying over 300 aircraft on the tarmac and routing Egyptian, Jordanian, and Syrian forces in six days, capturing 70,000 sq km of territory at a cost of 779 Israeli soldiers versus approximately 20,000 Arab dead.

1. Regional Flashpoints (1964–67)

WATER WARS, SAMU & APRIL 7 CLASH

  - Cairo Conference (1964):** Created the PLO and the **Palestine Liberation Army (PLA)** with 12,000 soldiers; Arab states agreed the **Headwater Diversion Plan** (diverting Hasbani and Banias tributaries) to starve Israel's National Water Carrier, provoking Israeli airstrikes.
  - Fatah Guerrilla Raids:** Founded in 1959 by Yasser Arafat; Fatah staged **over 70 sabotage raids** between 1965 and 1967 against Israeli water pumps, railways, and villages from Jordan, Syria, and Lebanon (none from Gaza due to UNEF).
2. The May Crisis & Ultimatums (1967)

SOVIET FALSE REPORTS & TIRAN CLOSURE

  - Soviet False Intelligence (13 May):** Moscow gave Nasser a false intelligence report claiming 10 to 12 Israeli brigades were massing for an invasion of Syria, pressuring Nasser to take aggressive action to maintain Arab leadership.
  - Nasser's Escalation (16–18 May):** Nasser ordered UNEF peacekeepers to evacuate Sinai buffer zones and mobilized **100,000 Egyptian troops and 1,000 tanks** directly to the Israeli frontier, putting the IDF on maximum alert.
3. Operation Focus & Tri-Front Rout

5–10 JUNE 1967 BLITZKRIEG

  - Operation Focus (5 June 1967):** At 7:45 AM, 200 Israeli jets flew 15 meters above the sea beneath Egyptian radar; using French runway-cratering bombs, they wiped out **over 300 Egyptian aircraft on the tarmac** in 3 hours, then demolished Syrian and Jordanian air forces.
  - Sinai Campaign (5–8 June):** Israeli armored columns under Sharon, Tal, and Yoffe smashed Egyptian defenses at Abu Ageila; Egyptian Field Marshal Amer ordered a panic retreat, allowing IDF tanks to ambush retreating columns at Mitla Pass.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                            | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Yitzhak Rabin</b><br/>IDF Chief of Staff who architected Operation Focus and directed the lightning tri-front ground campaign across Sinai, Jerusalem, and Golan.</div> | <div><b>Moshe Dayan</b><br/>Appointed Minister of Defence on 1 June 1967 in a National Unity Cabinet, boosting public morale and authorising the pre-emptive strike.</div> | <div><b>Gamal Abdel Nasser</b><br/>Egyptian President whose expulsion of UNEF, closure of Tiran, and 29 May ultimatums triggered the war; resigned in disgrace before mass protests reinstated him.</div> | <div><b>King Hussein of Jordan</b><br/>Signed May 30 mutual defense pact with Nasser; entered the war on false Egyptian victory reports, losing East Jerusalem and the West Bank in 48 hours.</div> |

**PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • MOTTA GUR, COMMANDER OF 55TH PARATROOPERS BRIGADE RADIO DISPATCH (7 JUNE 1967):**

IDF Central Command Audio Archives, Jerusalem Sector

*"The Temple Mount is in our hands! I repeat, the Temple Mount is in our hands! All forces stop firing, we are at the Western Wall!"*

**Historical Significance:** Captured the emotional and religious climax of the war, bringing the Old City of Jerusalem under Jewish sovereignty for the first time in 1,900 years.

**1. THE HEADWATER DIVERSION PLAN & SAMU RAID (1966)**

- **Jordan River Water Wars:** Arab states attempted to divert the Hasbani and Baniyas tributaries; Israel destroyed the engineering equipment with long-range tank and airstrikes.
- **Fatah Border Infiltrations:** Over 70 sabotage raids staged from Jordan, Syria, and Lebanon; none from Gaza because UNEF peacekeepers were stationed along the border.

**2. THE APRIL 7 DOGFIGHT & SOVIET DISINFORMATION**

- **Damascus Dogfight (7 April 1967):** Syrian gunners fired on an Israeli armored tractor; IAF fighter jets responded by downing **6 Syrian MiG-21s** and buzzing over Damascus.
- **Soviet Lie (13 May 1967):** Moscow claimed Israel was preparing to invade Syria; Nasser mobilized 100,000 troops in Sinai to prove he was still leader of the Arab world.

**3. OPERATION FOCUS: TOTAL AIR DECAPITATION (5 JUNE)**

- **Low-Level Flight:** 200 Israeli jets flew 15 meters above the Mediterranean waves beneath Egyptian radar, striking during the morning shift change when pilots were eating breakfast.
- **Dibber Bombs:** French rocket-assisted penetration bombs created massive craters in runways, trapping 300 Egyptian aircraft on the tarmac before destroying them.

**4. THE SPOILS: 70,000 SQ KM & QUADRUPLED BORDERS**

- **Territorial Conquests:** Israel seized the **Sinai Peninsula (60,000 sq km)**, the **West Bank (5,600 sq km)**, **Gaza Strip (360 sq km)**, and the **Golan Heights (1,200 sq km)**.
- **Asymmetric Casualties:** Israel lost **779 soldiers**; Arab armies suffered approximately **20,000 dead** (15,000 Egyptians, 6,000 Jordanians, 1,000 Syrians) and 80% equipment loss.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS****CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN****1. Water Clashes & Samu (1966)**

Fatah raids and Headwater Diversion provoke 13 Nov 1966 Samu raid (600 troops) and 7 April 1967 air clash (6 MiGs downed).

**2. Soviet Lie & May Brinkmanship**

13 May Soviet false alert prompts Nasser to expel UNEF, deploy 100k troops, close Straits of Tiran, and issue 29 May demands.

**3. Operation Focus Air Blitz**

5 June 7:45 AM: IAF destroys 300+ aircraft on tarmac in 3 hours; IDF armored columns break Egyptian lines in Sinai.

**4. Tri-Front Rout & 70,000 sq km**

Old City, West Bank, and Golan captured; 779 Israelis die vs ~20,000 Arabs; Israel quadruples territory in 6 days.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS****12 KEY TERMS**

**CAIRO SUMMIT (1964)** Arab League conference that established the PLO and the Palestine Liberation Army (PLA).

**7 APRIL 1967 DOGFIGHT** Air battle in which Israeli Mirage jets shot down 6 Syrian MiG-21s over Damascus.

**29 MAY DEMANDS** Nasser's public ultimatum demanding the return of all 1948 refugees and territory.

**70,000 SQ KM** Total land area captured by Israel (Sinai, Gaza, West Bank, Golan), quadrupling its size.

**HEADWATER DIVERSION** Arab project to divert Jordan River tributaries away from Israel's National Water Carrier.

**SOVIET FALSE ALERT** 13 May 1967 Moscow intelligence lie claiming Israel was massing brigades against Syria.

**OPERATION FOCUS** Surprise Israeli air strike on 5 June 1967 destroying 300+ Egyptian planes on the ground.

**MOTTA GUR** Commander of 55th Paratroopers Brigade who declared "The Temple Mount is in our hands!".

**SAMU RAID (NOV 1966)** Massive Israeli reprisal raid involving 600 troops and 11 tanks into the West Bank.

**STRAITS OF TIRAN** Strategic maritime chokepoint closed by Nasser on 22 May 1967, triggering the war.

**779 VS 20,000 DEAD** Casualty ratio of Israeli fatal losses compared to total Arab soldiers killed in 6 days.

**LEVI ESHKOL** Israeli Prime Minister who resisted early war calls before establishing National Unity cabinet.

**Land for Peace, The Three No's & The 350% Territorial Dilemma**

Israel emerged from the Six Day War controlling 350% more territory, transforming from a vulnerable enclave into the dominant military power in the Middle East. On 22 November 1967, the UN Security Council adopted Resolution 242, establishing the landmark "Land for Peace" formula: Israeli withdrawal from occupied territories in exchange for Arab recognition and secure borders. However, deliberate ambiguity in the English text ("territories occupied" rather than "the territories") allowed Israel to argue it could retain strategic border areas. The Arab League responded at the August 1967 Khartoum Summit with the intransigent "Three No's" (No peace, no recognition, no negotiation). Meanwhile, 300,000 new Palestinian refugees fled to Jordan, joining 618,500 Jewish refugees absorbed by Israel, while static clashes along the blocked Suez Canal escalated into the brutal War of Attrition (1969–70).

1. UN Resolution 242 (Nov 1967)

THE "LAND FOR PEACE" FORMULA

- The "Land for Peace" Formula:** Adopted unanimously by the UN Security Council; established the diplomatic trade-off: Israel would withdraw from occupied territories in exchange for Arab recognition and secure, recognized borders.
- Deliberate Linguistic Ambiguity:** The English text called for withdrawal from *"territories occupied in the recent conflict"*, omitting the word "the"; Israel argued this permitted partial retention of defensible borders, while Arabs demanded total 100% withdrawal.

2. The Occupied Territories Matrix

STRATEGIC DEPTH & 1M ARABS

- Sinai Peninsula (Egypt):** 60,000 sq km buffer containing Egypt's only oil reserves (Abu Rudeis); Israeli occupation prevented Egyptian use of the Suez Canal and secured permanent passage through the Straits of Tiran.
- Golan Heights (Syria):** Elevated plateau containing vital freshwater sources for the Sea of Galilee; eliminated Syrian artillery batteries that had shelled Israeli kibbutzim for two decades; 100,000 Syrians displaced.

3. Refugees & War of Attrition

JORDAN CAMPS & SOVIET SAMS

- The 1967 Refugee Wave:** Over **300,000 Palestinians** fled the **West Bank** across the Jordan River; most were crammed into 6 newly established, squalid refugee camps in Jordan, expanding PLO recruitment.
- The Jewish Refugee Contrast:** Israeli diplomats argued they had permanently resettled and integrated **618,500 Jewish refugees** expelled from Arab nations (1948–72), asserting that Arab states should similarly absorb Palestinian refugees.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                        | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Lord Caradon</b><br/>British UN Ambassador who drafted Resolution 242, deliberately phrasing the withdrawal clause to bridge Israeli and Arab positions.</div> | <div><b>Gamal Abdel Nasser</b><br/>Egyptian President who endorsed the Khartoum "Three No's" and waged the War of Attrition (1969–70) to bleed Israeli forces on the Suez Canal.</div> | <div><b>King Hussein of Jordan</b><br/>Ruler of Jordan who lost the West Bank and East Jerusalem, and was forced to absorb 300,000 new Palestinian refugees into his kingdom.</div> | <div><b>Golda Meir</b><br/>Became Israeli Prime Minister in 1969; oversaw the construction of the Bar-Lev Line and settlement building in the occupied territories.</div> |

PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • UN SECURITY COUNCIL RESOLUTION 242, OPERATIVE CLAUSE 1 (22 NOV 1967):

United Nations Document S/RES/242

*"Affirms that the fulfillment of Charter principles requires the establishment of a just and lasting peace in the Middle East which should include the application of both the following principles: (i) Withdrawal of Israel armed forces from territories occupied in the recent conflict; (ii) Termination of all claims or states of belligerency and respect for and acknowledgement of the sovereignty, territorial integrity and political independence of every State in the area..."*

**Historical Significance:** The cornerstone of all subsequent Middle Eastern peace diplomacy, despite conflicting interpretations of whether withdrawal applied to "all" territories.

**KEY TOPIC 2: THE ESCALATING CONFLICT, 1964–73**
**KT 2.2: The Aftermath of 1967 & UN Resolution 242: Forensic Analysis & Word Bank**
**1. UN RES 242: THE "LAND FOR PEACE" FORMULA**

- **Core Principles:** Resolution 242 paired Israeli territorial withdrawal with Arab recognition of Israel's right to live in peace within secure, recognized boundaries.
- **The English vs French Text:** The English version called for withdrawal from "territories occupied" (omitting "the"), whereas the French version specified "des territoires" (the territories), sparking endless legal disputes.

**2. STRATEGIC VALUE OF THE OCCUPIED TERRITORIES**

- **350% More Land:** Israel expanded from 20,000 sq km to nearly 90,000 sq km, gaining enormous strategic depth against surprise tank invasions from Egypt and Syria.
- **Sinai Oil & Depth:** Israel captured the Abu Rudeis oil fields, achieving petroleum self-sufficiency; Sinai provided a 200km desert buffer zone separating Cairo from Israel.

**3. THE 300,000 WEST BANK REFUGEES & JORDAN CAMPS**

- **Second Displacement Wave:** Over 300,000 Palestinians fled or were expelled from the West Bank across the Allenby Bridge into Jordan during and immediately after the war.
- **Six Squalid Emergency Camps:** UNRWA established six new emergency tent camps in Jordan (including Baqa'a), where refugees faced bitter winters and open-ditch sewage.

**4. THE WAR OF ATTRITION & SOVIET INTERVENTION**

- **Nasser's Strategy (1969–70):** Nasser calculated that Israel could not sustain long-term casualties: "If we kill 1,000 Israelis, they will collapse; if they kill 10,000 Egyptians, we will endure."
- **Bar-Lev Fortifications:** Israel built 35 fortified strongpoints connected by minefields along the canal bank to withstand constant Egyptian artillery bombardments.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS**
**CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN**
**1. Res 242 & Khartoum Rejection**

UN adopts "Land for Peace" (22 Nov 1967); Arab states counter with Khartoum "Three No's"; Palestinians reject refugee label.

**2. 350% More Land & Occupation**

Israel gains Sinai oil, Golan water, and West Bank buffer, but places 1m hostile Arabs under direct military rule.

**3. 300,000 Flee to Jordan Camps**

Second mass displacement wave enters Jordan; 6 new camps radicalize youth, fueling PLO guerrilla recruitment.

**4. War of Attrition (1969–70)**

Canal blocked; 20k Soviet troops intervene; 1,000 Israelis die on Bar-Lev Line before US brokers August 1970 ceasefire.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS**
**12 KEY TERMS**

**UN RESOLUTION 242** Nov 1967 Security Council resolution establishing the "Land for Peace" principle.

**350% LAND INCREASE** The massive territorial expansion achieved by Israel following the 1967 Six Day War.

**300,000 REFUGEES (1967)** Palestinians displaced from the West Bank into Jordan following the Six Day War.

**WAR OF ATTRITION** Brutal 1969–70 artillery and air war along the Suez Canal between Egypt and Israel.

**LAND FOR PEACE** Diplomatic concept: Israeli withdrawal in exchange for Arab recognition and secure borders.

**ABU RUDEIS** Major Egyptian oil fields in Sinai captured by Israel, providing domestic petroleum needs.

**618,500 JEWISH REFUGEES** Jews expelled from Arab and Muslim countries permanently resettled in Israel.

**20,000 SOVIET TROOPS** Soviet military technicians and missile crews deployed to Egypt to defend air space.

**KHARTOUM "THREE NO'S"** Aug 1967 Arab summit declaration: No peace, no recognition, and no negotiation with Israel.

**ANNEXATION OF JERUSALEM** Israel formally absorbed East Jerusalem into its municipality, declaring it undivided capital.

**BAR-LEV LINE** \$300m chain of 35 fortified bunkers and sand ramparts built along the Suez Canal.

**ROGERS PLAN CEASEFIRE** US-brokered August 1970 agreement that ended the War of Attrition along the canal.

**The Gun, The Skyjack & The Olympics: Terrorism Takes the World Stage**

The crushing defeat of Arab national armies in 1967 convinced Palestinian factions that they could no longer rely on Arab states. Under Yasser Arafat, Fatah transformed the PLO into an independent armed resistance movement. Following the 21 March 1968 Battle of Karameh, where fedayeen inflicted heavy losses on an Israeli raiding force, Arafat was elected PLO Chairman in 1969. Radical splinter factions, notably George Habash's Marxist Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP), pioneered international skyjackings. The September 1970 Dawson's Field hijackings provoked King Hussein to unleash the Jordanian army in "Black September", expelling the PLO to Lebanon by July 1971. In response, the Black September faction executed the 5 September 1972 Munich Olympics massacre, killing 11 Israeli athletes. Prime Minister Golda Meir responded with Operation Wrath of God, authorizing targeted assassinations across Europe.

1. Rise of Fatah & Karameh (1968)

FROM ARAB ARMIES TO ARMED GUERRILLAS

- Disillusionment with Arab Armies:** Arab military collapse in 1967 convinced Palestinians they could not rely on Arab regimes; Fatah and guerrilla factions advocated independent, armed "people's war" to liberate Palestine.
- Battle of Karameh (21 March 1968):** Following a school bus mining, the IDF raided Fatah's base at Karameh in Jordan; Fatah and Jordanian troops put up fierce resistance, inflicting heavy Israeli losses (28 dead, 4 tanks lost).

2. PFLP Skyjackings & Black September

DAWSON'S FIELD & THE EXPULSION

- PFLP Radical Ideology:** Founded in 1967 by George Habash (Marxist Palestinian Christian); believed international terrorism was essential to capture global media attention and force the world to confront the Palestinian issue.
- Dawson's Field Hijackings (Sept 1970):** PFLP commandos hijacked 4 international airliners; 3 planes were flown to a desert airstrip in Jordan (Dawson's Field) and 1 to Cairo; **56 Jewish passengers** were held hostage in exchange for prisoners.

3. Munich Olympics & Wrath of God

1972 HOSTAGE TRAGEDY & RETALIATION

- Birth of Black September:** A covert terrorist wing formed within Fatah to avenge the Jordanian expulsion; in Nov 1971, they assassinated Jordanian Prime Minister Wasfi al-Tel in Cairo, drinking his blood on hotel steps.
- Munich Olympics Attack (5 Sept 1972):** 8 Black September terrorists breached the Olympic Village; they killed 2 Israeli athletes and took 9 hostage, demanding the release of **234 Palestinian prisoners in Israel**.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                  | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Yasser Arafat</b><br>Fatah founder elected PLO Chairman in 1969; championed armed struggle but later balanced military action with international diplomacy. | <b>George Habash</b><br>Marxist founder of the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP); pioneered international skyjackings to publicize the cause. | <b>King Hussein of Jordan</b><br>King of Jordan who crushed the PLO during Black September 1970 and expelled guerrilla forces to preserve his Hashemite monarchy. | <b>Golda Meir</b><br>Israeli Prime Minister who ordered Operation Wrath of God to eliminate the Black September leaders responsible for Munich. |

PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • GEORGE HABASH, LEADER OF THE PFLP, INTERVIEW ONLife Magazine, Interview Transcript, SKYJACKING (1970):

June 1970

"When we hijack a plane it has more effect than if we killed a hundred Israelis in battle. For decades world public opinion was deaf to our tragedy. We had to take drastic actions to force the world to look at the Palestinian people."

**Historical Significance:** Articulated the strategic logic of 1970s Palestinian international terrorism: sacrificing moral standing to force the Palestinian tragedy onto television screens.

**KEY TOPIC 2: THE ESCALATING CONFLICT, 1964–73**
**KT 2.3: The Rise of Palestinian Resistance & International Terrorism: Forensic Analysis & Word Bank**
**1. THE BATTLE OF KARAMEH & ARAFAT'S ASCENDANCY**

- **The School Bus Trigger:** On 18 March 1968, a school bus hit a mine in southern Israel, killing 2 adults and injuring 28 children; Israel launched a massive punitive raid 3 days later.
- **Fierce Defense at Karameh:** Rather than fleeing, Fatah commandos fought alongside Jordanian artillery; 28 Israeli soldiers were killed, 69 wounded, and 4 tanks captured or abandoned.

**2. DAWSON'S FIELD HIJACKINGS & KING HUSSEIN'S CRACKDOWN**

- **Triple Airliner Seizure:** On 6 Sept 1970, PFLP commandos hijacked Swissair, TWA, and BOAC flights, landing them at a former RAF desert base in Jordan renamed "Revolution Airport".
- **56 Jewish Hostages Separated:** Non-Jewish passengers were released; 56 Jewish passengers and American crews were held hostage in desert heat to demand prisoner releases.

**3. THE MUNICH MASSACRE & FÜRSTENFELDBRUCK FIREFIGHT**

- **Olympic Village Infiltration:** 8 Black September militants scaled the perimeter fence with forged passes, entered 31 Connollystraße, shot wrestling coach Moshe Weinberg, and took 9 hostages.
- **234 Prisoner Demands:** Terrorists demanded the release of 234 Palestinian prisoners in Israel and German Baader-Meinhof terrorists; Golda Meir took an uncompromising stance: "No negotiations with terror."

**4. OPERATION WRATH OF GOD & INTERNATIONAL BACKLASH**

- **Committee X Authorization:** Golda Meir and Defence Minister Moshe Dayan established "Committee X" to secretly authorize Mossad assassination squads across Europe.
- **Targeted Killings:** Mossad assassinated PLO representatives in Rome, Paris, and Cyprus using concealed explosives in telephone handsets and beds.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS**
**1. Karameh Defense (Mar 1968)**

Fatah stands against IDF raid; 28 Israeli troops die; Arafat hailed as hero and elected PLO Chairman in Feb 1969.

**2. Dawson's Field Hijackings**

PFLP blows up 3 jetliners on live TV; King Hussein crushes PLO in Black September 1970; PLO flees to Lebanon.

**3. Munich Olympics Massacre**

Black September kills 11 Israeli athletes at 1972 Munich Games; airport ambush fails; global shock and condemnation.

**CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN**
**4. Operation Wrath of God**

Golda Meir orders Mossad assassination campaign; European operatives shot; Lillehammer mistake tarnishes Mossad.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS**
**12 KEY TERMS**

**FATAH** Palestinian national liberation movement founded in 1959 by Yasser Arafat, dominating the PLO.

**PFLP** Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine: Marxist splinter group founded by George Habash.

**FATAHLAND** Southern Lebanon region controlled by the PLO as an armed launchpad against northern Israel.

**FÜRSTENFELDBRUCK** Bavarian airfield where a botched German police rescue attempt ended in the massacre of the hostages.

**BATTLE OF KARAMEH (1968)** Clash between IDF and Fatah in Jordan; transformed Arafat into an Arab folk hero.

**DAWSON'S FIELD (1970)** Jordanian desert airstrip where PFLP blew up 3 hijacked international airliners on live TV.

**MUNICH OLYMPICS (1972)** Black September attack resulting in the slaughter of 11 Israeli athletes and coaches.

**OPERATION WRATH OF GOD** Covert Mossad targeted assassination campaign authorized by Golda Meir to avenge Munich.

**PLO CHAIRMAN (1969)** Arafat's election cementing independent Palestinian armed leadership over the PLO.

**BLACK SEPTEMBER (1970)** Jordanian military crackdown killing thousands of Palestinians and expelling the PLO to Lebanon.

**234 PRISONERS** The number of Palestinian militants demanded by the Munich terrorists in exchange for hostages.

**LILLEHAMMER AFFAIR (1973)** Botched Mossad operation in Norway killing an innocent Moroccan waiter, leading to arrests.

**The October Earthquake: Shattered Invincibility & The Global Oil Weapon**

Frustrated by diplomatic stalemate and Israel's refusal to negotiate over Sinai, Egyptian President Anwar Sadat prepared a limited war to force superpower intervention. In July 1972, Sadat expelled 15,000 Soviet advisers to demonstrate independence. On 6 October 1973 (Yom Kippur and Ramadan), Egypt and Syria launched a devastating coordinated surprise attack. Egyptian forces used high-pressure water cannons to breach the Bar-Lev Line, crossing the Suez Canal under a dense SAM-6 missile umbrella, while 1,400 Syrian tanks stormed the Golan Heights. Israel mobilized its reserves under extreme pressure; after early counter-attacks failed, General Ariel Sharon breached the canal at Deversoir, encircling the Egyptian Third Army. The US raised its military to DEFCON 3 nuclear alert after Soviet threats. Concurrently, OAPEC imposed an oil embargo, quadrupling oil prices and permanently transforming Western foreign policy.

1. Sadat's Strategy & Soviet Exit

BREAKING THE DIPLOMATIC STALEMATE

- Anwar Sadat's Dilemma:** Succeeded Nasser in Sept 1970; inherited a bankrupt Egyptian economy, food riots, and 1.5 million displaced citizens; sought to break the "no war, no peace" stalemate through a limited military shock.
- Rejection of Sadat's Peace Initiative:** In 1971, Sadat offered full peace in exchange for Israeli withdrawal from Sinai; Israeli Prime Minister Golda Meir rejected the offer, convinced of Israel's military invincibility.

2. Operation Badr & Golan Surprise

WATER CANNONS & THE SAM SHIELD

- Operation Badr (2 PM, 6 Oct 1973):** On Yom Kippur (the holiest Jewish fast day) and during Ramadan, Egyptian forces crossed the Suez Canal; high-pressure water cannons washed away the 20-meter Bar-Lev sand ramparts in 2 hours.
- The Anti-Tank & SAM Shield:** Soviet-supplied wire-guided SAGGER missiles and RPGs destroyed early Israeli tank counter-attacks; mobile SAM-6 air defense umbrellas downed over 40 Israeli jets, shattering the myth of IDF invincibility.

3. IDF Counter-Strike & Oil Weapon

SHARON'S CROSSING & DEFCON 3

- Sharon's Deversoir Crossing (15–16 Oct):** General Sharon exploited a gap between Egypt's Second and Third Armies, ferried tanks across the Suez Canal on pontoon bridges, and completely encircled the **20,000-strong Egyptian Third Army**.
- Superpower Resupply Race:** The USSR launched an emergency airlift to Cairo/Damascus; President Nixon launched **Operation Nickel Grass**, airlifting 22,000 tons of tanks, ammunition, and Phantoms to Israel.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                     | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Anwar Sadat</b></div> <div>Egyptian President who orchestrated the surprise crossing of the Suez Canal, shattering Israeli invincibility and regaining Arab honor.</div> | <div><b>Golda Meir</b></div> <div>Israeli Prime Minister caught off guard on Yom Kippur; secured vital US military airlift but was forced to resign in 1974 following the Agranat Commission.</div> | <div><b>Ariel Sharon</b></div> <div>IDF General who disobeyed orders to punch across the Suez Canal at Deversoir, encircling Egypt's Third Army and turning the tactical tide.</div> | <div><b>King Faisal of Saudi Arabia</b></div> <div>Saudi monarch who led OAPEC in imposing the historic oil embargo on Western nations, unleashing the economic power of Arab petroleum.</div> |

PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • ANWAR SADAT SPEECH TO EGYPTIAN PEOPLE ON THE CANAL CROSSING (16 OCT 1973):

Egyptian National Archives, Cairo

*"We have crossed the barrier that seemed impossible to cross. The myth of the invincible Israeli army has been buried in the sands of Sinai forever. We did not fight to conquer, but to liberate our occupied land and restore Arab dignity."*

**Historical Significance:** Expressed the profound psychological triumph of the war for the Arab world, transforming Sadat from an underestimated leader into an international statesman.

## KEY TOPIC 2: THE ESCALATING CONFLICT, 1964–73

**KT 2.4: The Yom Kippur War & The 1973 Oil Crisis: Forensic Analysis & Word Bank**
**1. SADAT'S DIPLOMATIC DEADLOCK & SOVIET EXPULSION**

- **The "No War, No Peace" Paralysis:** Between 1970 and 1973, Israel ignored Sadat's peace overtures; Sadat decided only a military crisis could compel US diplomatic pressure on Israel.
- **Expulsion of 15,000 Soviets (1972):** Sadat expelled Soviet military technicians because Moscow refused to deliver long-range offensive strike bombers.

**2. OPERATION BADR: HIGH-PRESSURE WATER & SAM UMBRELLA**

- **Water Cannons on the Sand Berm:** Egyptian engineers imported commercial firefighting pumps from Germany, spraying 3,000 cubic meters of sand away per hour to carve 60 vehicle gaps.
- **Soviet SAGGER Carnage:** Egyptian infantry armed with AT-3 SAGGER wire-guided anti-tank missiles decimated Israeli tanks counter-attacking without infantry screen.

**3. SHARON'S DEVERSOIR CROSSING & THIRD ARMY SIEGE**

- **The Turning Point (14 Oct):** Sadat ordered Egyptian armor to advance beyond the SAM umbrella to relieve pressure on Syria; Israel ambushed and destroyed 250 Egyptian tanks in hours.
- **Crossing the Canal (15–16 Oct):** General Sharon discovered a 20-mile gap between Egyptian Second and Third Armies; IDF commandos crossed in rubber dinghies followed by floating pontoon bridges.

**4. THE SUPERPOWER NUCLEAR ALERT & THE OAPEC OIL WEAPON**

- **Operation Nickel Grass:** Nixon ordered US Air Force C-5 Galaxies to fly round-the-clock airlifts directly to Israel, delivering 22,000 tons of tanks, electronic jamming gear, and munitions.
- **DEFCON 3 Nuclear Showdown:** Brezhnev threatened unilateral Soviet troop deployment to save the Third Army; Kissinger raised US military forces to DEFCON 3 nuclear alert for 24 hours.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS**
**CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN**
**1. Soviet Exit & Yom Kippur Strike**

Sadat expels 15k Soviets; launches Operation Badr 6 Oct; water cannons and SAGGERs breach Bar-Lev Line.

**2. Golan & Sinai Desperation**

1,400 Syrian tanks attack Golan; early IDF counter-attacks fail; Dayan warns "Third Temple is falling".

**3. Sharon Crosses & Third Army Cut**

Sharon punches through Deversoir gap; encircles 20k Egyptian troops; US Nickel Grass airlift delivers 22k tons.

**4. DEFCON 3 & OAPEC 400% Shock**

Soviet threats trigger US nuclear alert; OAPEC quadruples oil price (\$3 to \$12); US forced into active diplomacy.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS**
**12 KEY TERMS**

**ANWAR SADAT** Egyptian President who launched the surprise 1973 attack to break diplomatic stalemate.

**WATER CANNONS** High-pressure pumps used by Egyptian engineers to wash away the Bar-Lev sand ramparts.

**DEVERSOIR GAP** The seam between Egyptian Second and Third Armies exploited by Sharon to cross the canal.

**UN RESOLUTION 338** Ceasefire resolution adopted 22 Oct 1973 calling for immediate peace negotiations.

**15,000 SOVIET ADVISERS** Soviet personnel expelled by Sadat in July 1972 to demonstrate independence.

**SAGGER MISSILES** Soviet-supplied wire-guided anti-tank missiles that decimated Israeli armor.

**OPERATION NICKEL GRASS** Massive emergency US military airlift delivering 22,000 tons of supplies to Israel.

**OAPEC OIL EMBARGO** Arab oil production cuts and embargo against the US, quadrupling oil prices from \$3 to \$12.

**OPERATION BADR** Egyptian code name for the crossing of the Suez Canal on 6 October 1973.

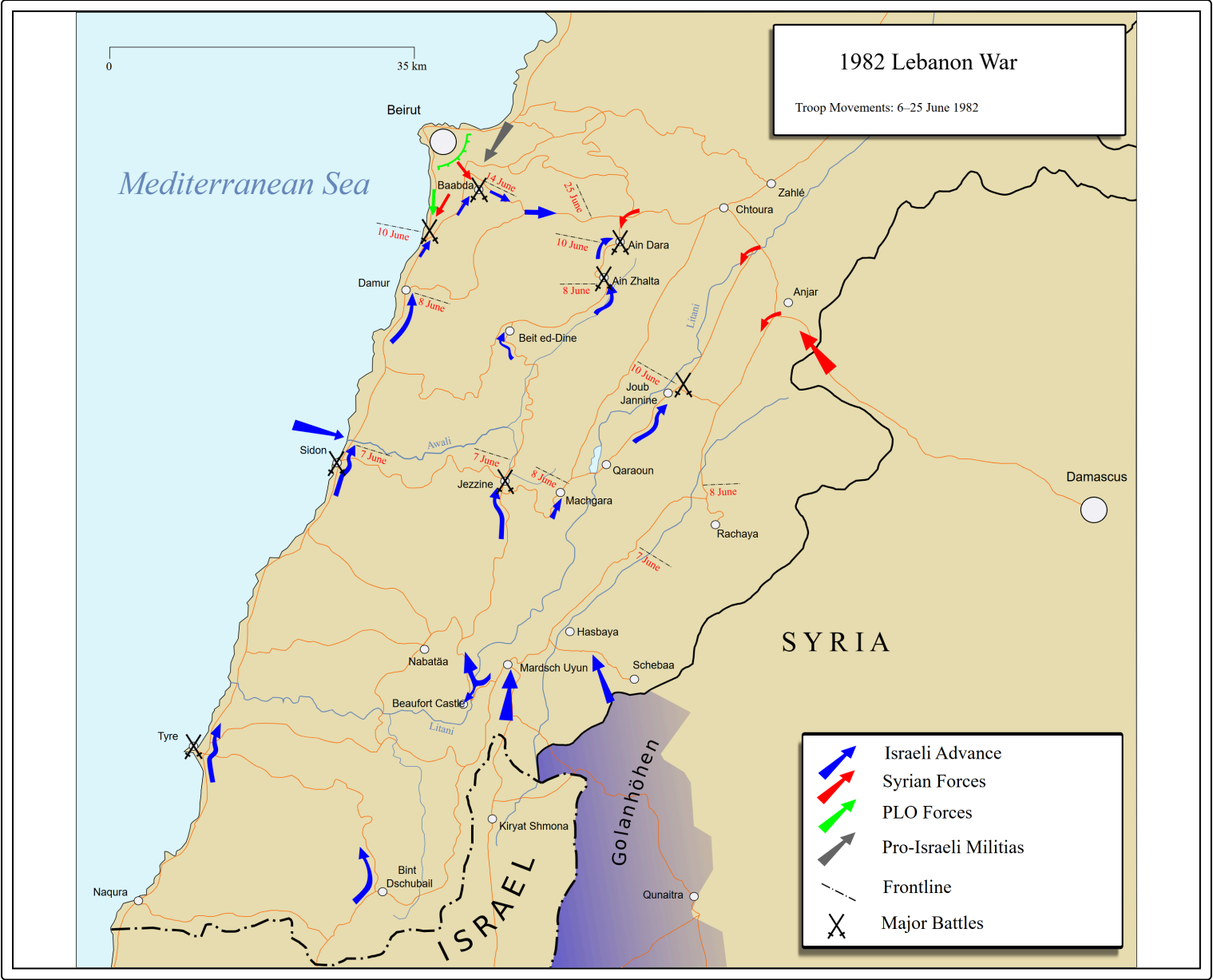
**SAM-6 UMBRELLA** Mobile surface-to-air missile shield protecting Egyptian forces along the canal.

**DEFCON 3** US military nuclear alert level ordered by Nixon and Kissinger during Soviet standoff.

**AGRANAT COMMISSION** Israeli judicial inquiry into war unpreparedness, leading to the resignations of Meir and Dayan.

THE 1982 ISRAELI INVASION OF LEBANON (OPERATION PEACE FOR GALILEE)

FACING ATLAS SPREAD  
• LEFT



1. MILITARY AIMS & OPERATION PEACE FOR GALILEE (6 JUNE 1982)

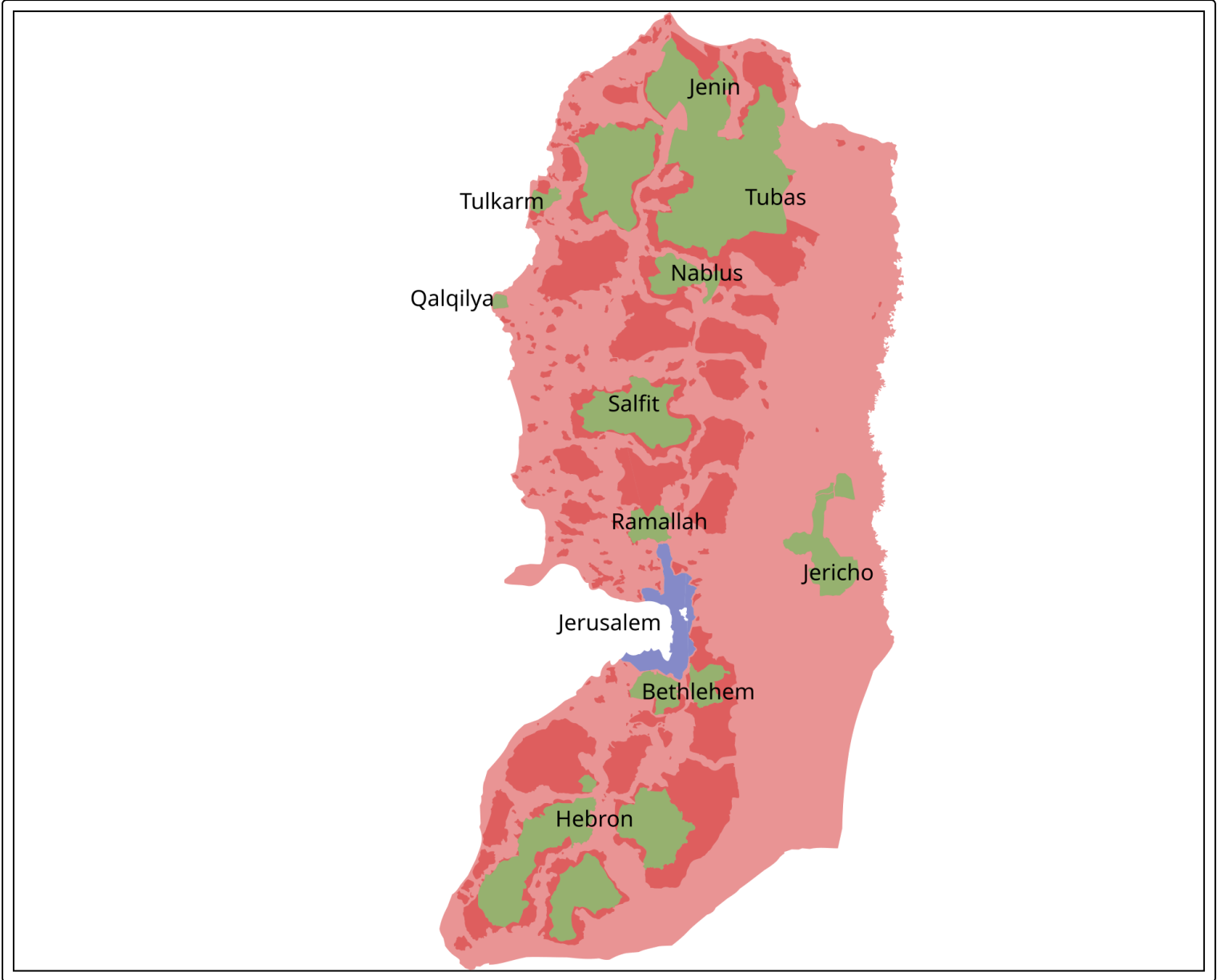
- **The 40km Buffer Zone Pretext:** Triggered by Abu Nidal assassination attempt on Israeli Ambassador Argov; stated aim was clearing a 40km artillery-free buffer.
- **Sharon's Deep Drive:** Defence Minister Ariel Sharon pushed 100km north past Tyre and Sidon, surrounding West Beirut and trapping Yasser Arafat's PLO.
- **Bekaa Valley Air Battle (Operation Mole Cricket 19):** Israeli Air Force destroyed 19 Syrian SAM batteries and shot down 82 Syrian MiGs without loss.

2. POLITICAL FALLOUT & SABRA-SHATILA MASSACRE

- **Siege & PLO Evacuation:** Heavy IDF bombardment of Beirut led to US-brokered evacuation of 14,000 PLO fighters by sea to Tunisia (Aug 1982).
- **Sabra & Shatila (Sept 1982):** Phalangist Christian militiamen massacred 800–3,500 Palestinian refugees under Israeli illumination flares.
- **Kahan Commission:** Found Sharon indirectly responsible for failing to prevent the massacre; forced his resignation; shattered Israeli domestic consensus.

THE OSLO II ADMINISTRATIVE DIVISION (AREAS A, B, AND C)

FACING ATLAS SPREAD • RIGHT



1. THE THREE ADMINISTRATIVE ZONES (OSLO II, 1995)

- **Area A (~3% of Land):** Full Palestinian National Authority (PNA) civil and security control. Comprised 8 major urban centres (Ramallah, Nablus, Jenin, Jericho, etc.).
- **Area B (~25% of Land):** PNA civil control with joint Israeli military security control. Comprised ~450 Palestinian villages.
- **Area C (~72% of Land):** Complete Israeli civil and military control. Encompassed all Israeli settlements, military bases, bypass roads, and Jordan Valley.

2. STRUCTURAL FLAWS & ROADBLOCKS TO PEACE

- **Fragmented "Swiss-Cheese" Enclaves:** Area A islands separated by Israeli-controlled Area C roads; Palestinian daily movement choked by military checkpoints.
- **Deferred Final Status Questions:** Oslo postponed the 4 most volatile issues: Jerusalem's sovereignty, borders, 1948 refugees' right of return, and Jewish settlements.
- **Extremist Backlash:** Hamas suicide bombings (Dizengoff bus) and the assassination of Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin by Yigal Amir (Nov 1995) derailed the peace process.

KT 3.1: Diplomatic Negotiations: Shuttle Diplomacy, Camp David & Treaty of Washington (1974–79)

Step-by-Step Diplomacy, Mine Clearance & The Knesset Speech

Following the 1973 Yom Kippur War and the devastating OAPEC oil shock, US foreign policy shifted toward active mediation. US Secretary of State Henry Kissinger engaged in intensive "shuttle diplomacy", flying between Cairo, Damascus, and Jerusalem to broker the 1974 Sinai I and 1975 Sinai II disengagement accords. In a massive engineering effort, 1,700 Egyptian troops cleared nearly 700,000 mines along the Suez Canal, allowing it to reopen on 5 June 1975 after eight years of paralysis. Facing catastrophic economic crises and violent food riots in Cairo in 1977, Egyptian President Anwar Sadat made the historic gamble of flying to Jerusalem on 19 November 1977 to address the Israeli Knesset directly. This breakthrough set the stage for US President Jimmy Carter to convene the 13-day Camp David summit in September 1978.

1. Kissinger's Shuttle Diplomacy

STEP-BY-STEP DISENGAGEMENT (1974–75)

- Step-by-Step Mediation:** Henry Kissinger traveled continuously between Middle Eastern capitals; because Arab states refused to speak directly to Israel, Kissinger acted as intermediary, exploiting Israel's total dependence on US military resupply.
- Sinai I Accord (Jan 1974):** Egypt and Israel agreed to mutual troop withdrawal from the Suez Canal and established a UN buffer zone, while Syria and Israel signed a May 1974 Golan accord monitored by UNDOF peacekeepers.

2. Reopening the Suez Canal

700,000 MINES & 5 JUNE 1975

- Eight-Year Paralysis:** The Suez Canal had been completely closed to international maritime commerce since the June 1967 Six Day War, stranding 15 cargo ships (the "Yellow Fleet") and costing Egypt hundreds of millions in toll fees.
- Massive Clearance Operation:** 1,700 Egyptian military engineers cleared nearly 700,000 landmines and unexploded ordnance from the canal's 164 km of banks; 96 Egyptian soldiers were killed during the dangerous three-month sweep.

3. Sadat's Journey to Jerusalem

FOOD RIOTS & THE KNESSET ADDRESS (1977)

- Cairo Food Riots (18–19 Jan 1977):** Violent riots against bread and fuel price increases killed 79 people and threatened Sadat's regime; Sadat realized Egypt was economically exhausted and could not maintain wartime spending.
- Historic Knesset Speech (20 Nov 1977):** Sadat stunned the world by declaring he would go "to the ends of the earth" for peace; he flew to Israel and spoke directly to the Knesset, offering full peace in exchange for complete Sinai withdrawal.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS

SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS

Henry Kissinger

US Secretary of State who pioneered "shuttle diplomacy", disengaging front-line armies and securing the lifting of the 1974 oil embargo.

Anwar Sadat

Egyptian President who boldly flew to Jerusalem in November 1977, addressing the Knesset and breaking 30 years of Arab diplomatic taboos.

Menachem Begin

Right-wing Likud Prime Minister of Israel who received Sadat in Jerusalem, agreeing to negotiate the return of the entire Sinai Peninsula.

Jimmy Carter

US President who prioritized Middle Eastern human rights and peace, investing enormous personal capital to broker the Camp David Accords.

PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • PRESIDENT ANWAR SADAT ADDRESS TO THE ISRAELI KNESSET (20 NOVEMBER 1977): Official Records of the Israeli Knesset, Special Session

"I come to you today on solid ground, to shape a new life, to establish peace... We really and truly welcome you to live among us in peace and security... There is no need for war. Let us end all suspicion and bloodshed forever."

**Historical Significance:** Marked the first time an Arab head of state set foot in Israel or recognized its existence, opening the door to bilateral peace.

**KEY TOPIC 3: ATTEMPTS AT A SOLUTION, 1974–95**
**KT 3.1: Diplomatic Negotiations: Shuttle Diplomacy, Camp David & Treaty of Washington (1974–79): Forensic Analysis & Word Bank**
**1. KISSINGER'S "SHUTTLE DIPLOMACY" ARCHITECTURE**

- **Bypassing the Arab Boycott:** Arab leaders refused to sit in the same room as Israeli negotiators; Kissinger flew over 30 round-trip missions carrying handwritten compromise drafts between Cairo, Damascus, and Jerusalem.
- **Exploiting Israeli Dependence:** Kissinger used Israel's desperate need for US financial credits, Phantom jets, and modern munitions following Yom Kippur losses to pressure Golda Meir and Yitzhak Rabin into territorial concessions.

**2. CLEARING THE SUEZ CANAL (700K MINES & 5 JUNE 1975)**

- **Canal Clearance Danger:** 1,700 Egyptian engineers cleared 700,000 mines along 164 km of banks; 96 men died in three months from exploding ordnance, illustrating the human sacrifice required to reopen world trade.
- **Dredging the Waterway:** Operation Nimbus Stream and Nimbus Moon deployed US, British, French, and Egyptian naval divers to remove 10 sunken cargo vessels, military bridge causeways, and thousands of live mortar shells and rockets.

**3. ECONOMIC CRISIS & CAIRO BREAD RIOTS (JAN 1977)**

- **Economic Insolvency:** Decades of continuous wartime mobilization left Egypt with \$12 billion in foreign debt, collapsing infrastructure, soaring unemployment, and runaway inflation.
- **Food Riots (18–19 Jan 1977):** When the Egyptian government abruptly cut basic food and fuel subsidies to satisfy International Monetary Fund (IMF) loan requirements, violent riots erupted across Cairo and Alexandria, killing 79 people.

**4. THE HISTORIC KNESSET SPEECH (20 NOVEMBER 1977)**

- **Stunning the Arab World:** Sadat announced to the Egyptian National Assembly that he was willing to go to the Israeli Knesset; Arab allies reacted with fury, but Israeli Prime Minister Menachem Begin promptly issued an official invitation.
- **Arrival in Tel Aviv:** On 19 Nov 1977, Sadat landed at Ben Gurion Airport and was received by an Israeli military honor guard, shaking hands with Golda Meir, Yitzhak Rabin, and Ariel Sharon on live international television.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS**
**1. Yom Kippur War & Oil Shock**

1973 war & 400% oil price rise shatter status quo; US foreign policy compelled to actively intervene in Middle East.

**2. Kissinger Shuttle Diplomacy**

Kissinger flies between capitals; Sinai I & II disengagements agreed; OASPEC lifts oil embargo in March 1974.

**3. Suez Cleared & Reopened**

1,700 engineers clear 700k mines (96 dead); canal reopens 5 June 1975; Egypt regains vital transit tolls.

**CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN**
**4. Sadat in Jerusalem (1977)**

Food riots pressure Sadat; he flies to Israel, addresses Knesset; breaks 30-year taboo, paving way to Camp David.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS**
**12 KEY TERMS**

**SHUTTLE DIPLOMACY** Intensive diplomatic mediation by Henry Kissinger traveling between Middle Eastern capitals.

**5 JUNE 1975 REOPENING** Historic reopening of Suez Canal exactly 8 years after the Six Day War closure.

**SADAT IN JERUSALEM (1977)** Historic breakthrough when Sadat addressed the Knesset offering full peace.

**ISMAILIA SUMMIT (1977)** Reciprocal summit in Egypt where Begin and Sadat continued bilateral peace talks.

**SINAI I & II ACCORDS** 1974 and 1975 disengagement treaties pulling Israeli forces back from the Suez Canal.

**ABU RUDEIS OILFIELDS** Strategic Sinai oil installations returned to Egyptian control under the Sinai II agreement.

**MENACHEM BEGIN** Israeli Prime Minister who hosted Sadat in Jerusalem and signed the Camp David Accords.

**UNDOF BUFFER ZONE** UN peacekeeping force deployed to the Golan Heights following the 1974 Syrian disengagement.

**SUEZ CANAL CLEARANCE** 1,700 engineers cleared 700,000 mines (96 dead); reopened on 5 June 1975.

**CAIRO FOOD RIOTS (1977)** Violent protests against price hikes that pushed Sadat to urgently seek peace.

**JIMMY CARTER** US President whose personal diplomacy brought Sadat and Begin together at Camp David.

**GIDI & MITLA PASSES** Crucial mountain defiles in Sinai evacuated by Israel under the 1975 Sinai II Accord.

**Thirteen Days, Billions in Aid & The Price of Treason: Camp David 1978–79**

In September 1978, US President Jimmy Carter isolated Anwar Sadat and Menachem Begin at the Camp David presidential retreat for 13 days of grueling negotiations. The summit produced two distinct agreements: the Framework for Egyptian-Israeli Peace (full Sinai withdrawal in exchange for mutual recognition) and the deliberately vague Framework for Peace in the Middle East (promising 5-year transitional autonomy for West Bank and Gaza Palestinians). Carter sealed the deal with massive US financial underwriting: \$10 billion in aid to Egypt (\$1 billion annually for 10 years) and \$3 billion in loans/grants to Israel for replacement Negev airbases. On 26 March 1979, the formal Treaty of Washington was signed on the White House lawn. While Sadat and Begin shared the 1978 Nobel Peace Prize, the Arab world reacted with fury: the Arab League expelled Egypt, and on 6 October 1981, Sadat was assassinated by Egyptian Islamic Jihad militants.

1. The 13 Days at Camp David (1978)

CARTER'S HIGH-STAKES SUMMIT

  - Total Diplomatic Isolation:** In Sept 1978, Carter brought Sadat and Begin to Maryland; when the two leaders refused to speak to each other after day three, Carter personally drafted and redrafted compromise proposals 23 times.
  - Sinai vs Settlements Impasse:** Begin agreed to return the Sinai Peninsula, but adamantly refused to dismantle Israeli settlements (e.g. Yamit) or concede sovereignty over the West Bank and East Jerusalem.
2. The Two Frameworks & US Aid

\$10BN EGYPT / \$3BN ISRAEL PACKAGES

  - Framework 1 (Sinai Peace):** Israel would return all of Sinai within three years, dismantle all Jewish settlements, and restore Egyptian sovereignty; Egypt recognized Israel and granted navigation rights in Suez and Aqaba.
  - Framework 2 (Palestinian Autonomy):** Envisioned an elected self-governing authority for West Bank and Gaza for 5 years, followed by final-status talks; however, Palestinians were not consulted, and the terms were deliberately vague.
3. The Treaty & Fatal Backlash

WASHINGTON 1979 & SADAT ASSASSINATION

  - Treaty of Washington (26 March 1979):** Signed on the White House lawn; Egypt became the first Arab state to officially recognize Israel's right to exist in peace, ending 31 years of official warfare.
  - Arab League Expulsion:** Arab nations denounced Sadat as a traitor who abandoned Palestine; Egypt was expelled from the Arab League, the League HQ was moved from Cairo to Tunis, and Gulf states cut off financial subsidies.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Jimmy Carter</b><br/>US President whose relentless 13-day personal mediation at Camp David produced the historic peace accords and treaties.</div> | <div><b>Anwar Sadat</b><br/>Egyptian President who regained Sinai and billions in US aid, but was ostracized by the Arab world and assassinated in 1981.</div> | <div><b>Menachem Begin</b><br/>Israeli Prime Minister who conceded Sinai and dismantled the Yamit settlement, while retaining military control over the West Bank and Gaza.</div> | <div><b>Hosni Mubarak</b><br/>Sadat's Vice President who survived the 1981 assassination attack, became Egyptian President, and upheld the peace treaty with Israel.</div> |

PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • EGYPT-ISRAEL PEACE TREATY, ARTICLE I (26 MARCH 1979):

Treaty of Washington, United Nations Treaty Series No. 17813

*"The state of war between the Parties will be terminated and peace will be established between them upon the exchange of instruments of ratification of this Treaty... Israel will withdraw all its armed forces and civilians from the Sinai... Egypt will resume the exercise of its full sovereignty over the Sinai."*

**Historical Significance:** Permanently eliminated Israel's most powerful military opponent from the Arab coalition, fundamentally altering the Middle Eastern balance of power.

**KEY TOPIC 3: ATTEMPTS AT A SOLUTION, 1974–95**
**KT 3.2: Camp David Accords (1978), Treaty of Washington (1979) & Backlash: Forensic Analysis & Word Bank**
**1. THE 13-DAY DRAMA AT CAMP DAVID (SEPT 1978)**

- **Total Seclusion:** Carter kept the delegations cut off from the media at the wooded Maryland retreat; Sadat and Begin developed such mutual hostility they could not meet face-to-face after day three.
- **Carter's 23 Drafts:** Carter worked 18-hour days shuttling between Sadat's and Begin's cabins, personally writing, redrafting, and negotiating 23 separate iterations of the peace text.

**2. THE US FINANCIAL PACKAGES (\$10BN & \$3BN)**

- **\$10 Billion to Egypt:** The US pledged \$10 billion in civilian and military grants over a decade (\$1 billion annually), modernizing Egypt's infrastructure, subsidizing wheat imports, and supplying modern M60 Patton tanks.
- **\$3 Billion to Israel:** The US funded the construction of two state-of-the-art military airbases (Nevatim and Ramon) in the Negev Desert to replace bases surrendered in Sinai, guaranteeing Israel's qualitative military edge.

**3. WHY PALESTINIANS REJECTED THE FRAMEWORK**

- **Zero Consultation:** The PLO and West Bank Palestinians were completely excluded from the Camp David negotiations, viewing Sadat as a traitor who sold out Palestinian rights to regain Egyptian sovereign territory.
- **No Guarantee of Statehood:** Framework 2 promised only "administrative autonomy" after 5 years, leaving internal security, border control, water rights, and land ownership firmly in the hands of the IDF.

**4. THE ARAB BACKLASH & 1981 ASSASSINATION**

- **Arab League Sanctions:** Meeting in Baghdad, 18 Arab nations suspended Egypt from the Arab League, moved the League headquarters from Cairo to Tunis, and imposed a total diplomatic, cultural, and economic boycott.
- **Saudi Subsidy Cut:** Saudi Arabia and Kuwait immediately terminated billions in annual financial subsidies that had supported Egypt's treasury since the 1967 Khartoum summit, leaving Egypt wholly reliant on US aid.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS**
**CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN**
**1. 13-Day Camp David Summit**

Carter isolates Sadat & Begin in Maryland; drafts 23 proposals; brokers two historic peace frameworks.

**2. US Aid Underwriting**

US pledges \$10bn to Egypt (\$1bn/yr) and \$3bn to Israel for replacement Negev airbases; seals treaty.

**3. Treaty of Washington (1979)**

Peace signed on White House lawn; Sinai returned over 3 years; Egypt becomes first Arab state to recognize Israel.

**4. Arab Boycott & Assassination**

Arab League expels Egypt to Tunis; Islamists view treaty as treason; Sadat assassinated at military parade in 1981.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS**
**12 KEY TERMS**

**CAMP DAVID ACCORDS (1978)** Two peace frameworks brokered by President Jimmy Carter at the Maryland retreat.

**\$10 BILLION US EGYPT AID** Financial package (\$1bn/yr for 10 years) pledged by Carter to stabilize Egypt.

**YAMIT SETTLEMENT** Major Israeli settlement in Sinai bulldozed by the IDF before returning the land to Egypt.

**KHALID ISLAMBOULI** Egyptian Islamic Jihad army officer who led the assassination of Anwar Sadat.

**FRAMEWORK FOR SINAI PEACE**

Agreement returning full Sinai Peninsula to Egypt in exchange for diplomatic recognition.

**\$3 BILLION US ISRAEL AID** US grants and loans funding replacement Israeli military airbases in the Negev.

**ARAB LEAGUE EXPULSION** Arab states suspended Egypt from the Arab League, relocating headquarters to Tunis.

**HOSNI MUBARAK** Succeeded Sadat as Egyptian President, maintaining the peace treaty while thawing Arab ties.

**FRAMEWORK FOR MIDDLE EAST** Vague proposal for 5-year transitional Palestinian autonomy, boycotted by Palestinians.

**TREATY OF WASHINGTON (1979)** Formal peace treaty between Egypt and Israel signed on the White House lawn.

**SADAT ASSASSINATION (1981)** Murder of Anwar Sadat on 6 Oct 1981 by Islamic Jihad during a military parade.

**NOBEL PEACE PRIZE (1978)** Awarded jointly to Anwar Sadat and Menachem Begin for negotiating the peace accords.

**Siege, Massacre & Stones: The Lebanon War to the First Intifada**

Following expulsion from Jordan in 1970, the PLO constructed a heavily armed "state-within-a-state" among 300,000 refugees in southern Lebanon ("Fatahland"). The March 1978 Coastal Road Massacre (38 Israeli civilians killed) prompted Operation Litani, deploying 26,000 IDF troops. On 6 June 1982, following the attempted assassination of Israeli Ambassador Shlomo Argov in London by the anti-Arafat Abu Nidal faction, Defence Minister Ariel Sharon launched Operation Peace for Galilee, besieging Beirut for two months. After the PLO evacuated to Tunis, Christian Phalangists slaughtered between 800 and 3,500 Palestinian civilians in the Sabra and Shatila refugee camps, provoking the Kahan Commission to oust Sharon and inadvertently birthing Hezbollah. Frustration in the occupied territories erupted on 8 December 1987 in the First Intifada, led by the Unified National Leadership of the Uprising (UNLU). Despite Israel's "Iron Fist" policy, international TV footage of stone-throwing youths against tanks shifted world opinion, resulting in 1,200 Palestinian deaths by the IDF and over 800 executions of suspected collaborators.

**1. Fatahland & Operation Litani****300K REFUGEES & 1978 BUS RAID**

- **Fatahland in South Lebanon:** 300,000 Palestinian refugees lived in Lebanon; the PLO built a heavily armed military enclave, firing Soviet Katyusha rockets into northern Israeli towns like Kiryat Shmona and Nahariya.
- **Coastal Road Massacre (11 March 1978):** 11 Fatah commandos landed by boat, hijacked a bus near Tel Aviv, and engaged in a shootout killing **38 Israeli civilians (including 13 children)** and wounding 71.

**2. Lebanon Invasion & Sabra-Shatila****OPERATION PEACE FOR GALILEE (1982)**

- **The Assassination Pretext:** On 3 June 1982, the Abu Nidal group (anti-Arafat extremists) shot and paralyzed Israeli Ambassador Shlomo Argov in London; Defence Minister Ariel Sharon seized on this to launch a full invasion on 6 June 1982.
- **Two-Month Siege of Beirut:** Sharon told cabinet troops would advance only 40km, but pushed 85km to surround West Beirut, cutting water, electricity, and food while relentlessly bombing residential areas for two months.

**3. The First Intifada (1987–93)****JABALYA SPARK & GRASSROOTS REVOLT**

- **The Jabalya Spark (8 Dec 1987):** An IDF tank transporter crashed into four civilian cars at Jabalya refugee camp in Gaza, killing 4 Palestinians; rumors of deliberate revenge triggered mass rioting across Gaza and the West Bank.
- **UNLU & Civil Disobedience:** The Unified National Leadership of the Uprising (UNLU) distributed clandestine leaflets organizing general strikes, commercial boycotts, tax withholding, and barricades, catching PLO leaders in Tunis off guard.

**KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS****SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS****Ariel Sharon**

Israeli Defence Minister who drove the 1982 invasion into Beirut; forced to resign after the Kahan Commission found him personally responsible for Sabra-Shatila.

**Yasser Arafat**

PLO Chairman who commanded the defense of Beirut, was evacuated by sea to Tunis in 1982, and was caught completely off guard by the 1987 Intifada.

**Yitzhak Rabin**

Israeli Defence Minister who enforced the "Iron Fist" policy during the Intifada, before concluding that military force could never solve the Palestinian issue.

**Sheikh Ahmed Yassin**

Quadriplegic Muslim Brotherhood leader in Gaza who founded the militant Islamist movement Hamas in December 1987 during the opening days of the Intifada.

**PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • REPORT OF THE KAHAN COMMISSION OF INQUIRY (7 FEBRUARY 1983):****Official Judicial Publication, State of Israel**

*"It is impossible to justify the Minister of Defence's disregard of the danger of a massacre... He bears personal responsibility for not ordering appropriate measures to prevent or impede the entry of the Phalangists into the camps."*

**Historical Significance:** An extraordinary self-indictment by a democratic state investigating its own military conduct, forcing the resignation of Defence Minister Ariel Sharon.

**KEY TOPIC 3: ATTEMPTS AT A SOLUTION, 1974–95**
**KT 3.3: The Palestinian Issue: The 1982 Lebanon War & The First Intifada (1987–93): Forensic Analysis & Word Bank**
**1. THE COASTAL ROAD MASSACRE & OPERATION LITANI (1978)**

- **Bus Hijacking (11 March 1978):** 11 Fatah commandos landed by Zodiac dinghy from Lebanon, seized an intercity bus on the Coastal Highway, and shot at motorists; 38 civilians (including 13 children) died in the fiery standoff.
- **26,000 IDF Troops Invade:** PM Menachem Begin ordered Operation Litani; Israeli troops pushed to the Litani River, killing 300 PLO fighters, destroying training bases, and displacing 100,000 Lebanese civilians.

**2. SHLOMO ARGOV PRETEXT & THE 1982 BEIRUT SIEGE**

- **The London Pretext:** Ambassador Argov was paralyzed by Abu Nidal assassins in London; despite British intelligence confirming Abu Nidal was Arafat's deadly enemy, Sharon seized the shooting to justify invading Lebanon.
- **The Deceptive 40km Mandate:** Sharon told the Israeli cabinet the invasion would penetrate only 40km to clear artillery range, but deliberately drove 85km north to surround Beirut and link up with Christian Phalangist allies.

**3. SABRA-SHATILA MASSACRE & THE RISE OF HEZBOLLAH**

- **Phalangist Revenge (16–18 Sept 1982):** Following the assassination of Lebanese President Bashir Gemayel, Israeli commanders allowed Christian Phalangist militias into the defenseless Sabra and Shatila refugee camps.
- **800 to 3,500 Slaughtered:** For 36 hours, Phalangists butchered unarmed women, children, and elderly men with axes, knives, and automatic weapons while Israeli troops fired illumination flares over the camps.

**4. THE INTIFADA TOLL (1,200 IDF / 800 COLLABORATORS)**

- **Grassroots Popular Uprising (1987–93):** Frustration with 20 years of military occupation exploded spontaneously in Jabalya; driven by local youths throwing stones and petrol bombs rather than the exiled PLO leadership in Tunis.
- **UNLU Leaflets & Resistance:** The Unified National Leadership distributed secret leaflets directing strikes, commercial shutdowns, and underground schooling when Israel shut West Bank schools for two years.

**CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS**
**CAUSE & CONSEQUENCE CHAIN**
**1. Fatahland & Coastal Road**

300k refugees in Lebanon; PLO establishes Fatahland; 1978 bus massacre kills 38; Op Litani deploys 26k troops.

**2. Argov Attack & Beirut Siege**

Abu Nidal shoots Argov in London; Sharon invades Lebanon; 2-month siege of Beirut forces PLO evacuation to Tunis.

**3. Sabra-Shatila & Hezbollah**

Phalangists slaughter 800–3,500 refugees; Kahan Commission ousts Sharon; invasion births Iranian-backed Hezbollah.

**4. First Intifada (1987–93)**

Jabalya crash sparks revolt; UNLU coordinates civil disobedience; 1,200 killed by IDF, 800 collaborators executed.

**★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK & ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS**
**12 KEY TERMS**

**FATAHLAND** Armed PLO enclave established in southern Lebanon among 300,000 Palestinian refugees.

**SHLOMO ARGOV** Israeli Ambassador in London shot by Abu Nidal in 1982, providing the pretext for invasion.

**PHILIP HABIB** US special envoy who negotiated the peaceful maritime evacuation of 14,000 PLO fighters to Tunis.

**HEZBOLLAH** Radical Iranian-funded Lebanese Shi'ite militant movement formed to resist Israeli occupation.

**COASTAL ROAD MASSACRE** 1978 Fatah bus hijacking killing 38 Israeli civilians (13 children), triggering Op Litani.

**OPERATION PEACE FOR GALILEE** Full-scale Israeli invasion of Lebanon launched on 6 June 1982 by Ariel Sharon.

**SABRA AND SHATILA** Massacre of 800 to 3,500 Palestinian civilians by Christian Phalangist militia in Sept 1982.

**FIRST INTIFADA (1987–93)** Mass Palestinian popular uprising in West Bank and Gaza against Israeli military rule.

**OPERATION LITANI (1978)** Israeli military invasion of southern Lebanon deploying 26,000 troops to push back PLO.

**SIEGE OF BEIRUT (1982)** Two-month IDF military siege cutting water, food, and power to West Beirut.

**KAHAN COMMISSION** Israeli judicial commission that found Defence Minister Ariel Sharon personally responsible.

**UNLU** Unified National Leadership of the Uprising, directing underground strikes and civil disobedience.

**Recognition, Land Divisions & Assassination: The Rise and Fall of Oslo**

Between 1988 and 1995, seismic geopolitical shifts transformed the Middle East. In December 1988, Yasser Arafat renounced terrorism and recognized Israel in Geneva. The 1990–91 Gulf War dealt the PLO a devastating financial blow when Saudi Arabia and Kuwait expelled 400,000 Palestinians and severed funding following Arafat's support for Saddam Hussein, while the collapse of the USSR brought over 600,000 Soviet Jewish immigrants to Israel. Bankrupted and marginalized, the PLO engaged in secret negotiations hosted by Norwegian Foreign Minister Johan Jørgen Holst, culminating in the Oslo I Accord signed on 13 September 1993. The agreement established the Palestinian Authority (PA) in 1994, led to the historic October 1994 Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty, and was followed by the September 1995 Oslo II agreement dividing the West Bank into Areas A (3%), B (25%), and C (72%). However, mounting Hamas suicide bus bombings and the assassination of Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin on 4 November 1995 shattered hopes for lasting peace.

1. Geopolitical Seismic Shifts

GENEVA 1988 & GULF WAR DISASTER

- Arafat Renounces Terrorism (Dec 1988):** Arafat addressed the UN in Geneva, officially recognizing Israel's right to exist, renouncing all terrorism, and accepting Res 242; the US opened formal diplomatic dialogue with the PLO.
- 1990–91 Gulf War Disaster:** Arafat publicly backed Saddam Hussein's invasion of Kuwait; when Iraq lost, **Kuwait and Saudi Arabia expelled 400,000 Palestinians and cut off all funding**, leaving the PLO completely bankrupt.

2. Oslo I & The Historic Handshake

SECRET TALKS & WHITE HOUSE LAWN (1993)

- Secret Oslo Channel (1992–93):** Israeli academics and PLO officials met covertly outside Oslo, hosted by Norwegian Foreign Minister Johan Jørgen Holst, bypassing the formal, stalled Madrid negotiating track.
- Letters of Mutual Recognition:** The PLO recognized Israel's right to exist in peace and security and renounced terrorism; Israel officially recognized the PLO as the legitimate representative of the Palestinian people.

3. Oslo II, Jordan Peace & Murder

AREAS A/B/C & RABIN ASSASSINATION

- Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty (Oct 1994):** King Hussein and Yitzhak Rabin signed a formal peace treaty at Wadi Araba, with the US cancelling Jordan's debt; Jordan became the second Arab nation to establish full peace with Israel.
- Oslo II Agreement (Sept 1995):** Divided the West Bank into three administrative zones: **Area A (3% of land)** under full PA control; **Area B (25% of land)** under PA civil and joint Israeli security control; **Area C (72% of land)** under full Israeli civil and military control.

| KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES & ORGANISATIONS                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                 | SPECIFICATION PROTAGONISTS                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Yitzhak Rabin</b></div> <div>Israeli Prime Minister who traded land for peace, signed Oslo I and the Jordan peace treaty, and was assassinated on 4 Nov 1995.</div> | <div><b>Yasser Arafat</b></div> <div>PLO Chairman who accepted mutual recognition, returned to Gaza in July 1994 as head of the PA, and was elected PA President in 1996.</div> | <div><b>Bill Clinton</b></div> <div>US President who hosted the 13 Sept 1993 White House signing ceremony and orchestrated the historic Rabin-Arafat handshake.</div> | <div><b>King Hussein of Jordan</b></div> <div>Monarch who signed the historic October 1994 peace treaty with Israel at Wadi Araba, ending a 46-year official state of war.</div> |

PRIMARY ARCHIVAL EVIDENCE • PRIME MINISTER YITZHAK RABIN ADDRESS AT THE WHITE HOUSE (13 SEPT 1993):

US Department of State Dispatch, Vol. 4, No. 38

*"We, the soldiers who have returned from the battlefields stained with blood... We who have fought against you, the Palestinians, we say to you today in a loud and clear voice: Enough of blood and tears! Enough!"*

**Historical Significance:** A war hero and general explicitly rejecting further violence, committing Israel to mutual recognition and the peace process.

## KEY TOPIC 3: ATTEMPTS AT A SOLUTION, 1974–95

## KT 3.4: Attempts at a Solution: From the Oslo Accords to Oslo II (1993–95):

## Forensic Analysis &amp; Word Bank

## 1. THE GULF WAR FINANCIAL DISASTER &amp; SOVIET ALIYAH

- **Arafat's Gulf War Blunder:** By publicly embracing Saddam Hussein during the 1990 invasion of Kuwait, Arafat alienated wealthy Gulf monarchies; upon liberation, Kuwait expelled 400,000 Palestinian workers.
- **Financial Ruin:** The PLO lost \$100 million annually in Arab subsidies and worker remittances, bankrupting its institutions, schools, and hospitals, leaving Arafat desperate for a diplomatic breakthrough to retain power.

## 2. THE OSLO SECRET NEGOTIATIONS &amp; MUTUAL RECOGNITION

- **Norwegian Discretion:** Norwegian social scientist Terje Rød-Larsen and Foreign Minister Johan Jørgen Holst organized 14 secret meetings in rural Norwegian mansions, shielding negotiators from public pressure.
- **Breaking Taboos:** For the first time, Israeli officials sat directly with PLO leaders; they bypassed thorny final-status issues (Jerusalem, refugees, borders) to achieve an interim breakthrough based on "land for peace".

## 3. THE OSLO II WEST BANK DIVISION (AREAS A, B, C)

- **Area A (3% of West Bank):** Encompassed the 8 major Palestinian cities (Jenin, Nablus, Tulkarm, Qalqilya, Ramallah, Bethlehem, Jericho, Hebron); full PA civil administration and internal security control.
- **Area B (25% of West Bank):** Covered 450 Palestinian rural towns and villages (approx. 68% of Palestinian population); PA exercised civil administration, but the IDF retained overriding military security control.

## 4. THE EXTREMIST SABOTAGE &amp; RABIN'S ASSASSINATION

- **Hamas & Islamic Jihad Suicide Bombings:** Militant Islamists opposed conceding Islamic waqf land; suicide bombings in Afula, Hadera, and Tel Aviv commuter buses killed dozens of civilians, turning Israeli public opinion against Oslo.
- **Hebron Mosque Massacre (25 Feb 1994):** US-born Jewish extremist Baruch Goldstein opened fire with an assault rifle inside the Ibrahimi Mosque in Hebron, murdering 29 Palestinian worshippers during morning Ramadan prayers.

## CAUSAL PATHWAY: KEY HISTORICAL MECHANISMS

## CAUSE &amp; CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

## 1. Geneva 1988 &amp; Gulf Crisis

Arafat renounces terrorism; backing Saddam alienates Gulf states; Kuwait expels 400k Palestinians; PLO goes bankrupt.

## 2. Soviet Aliyah &amp; Secret Oslo

600k Soviet Jews arrive; Holst hosts secret Norwegian channel; Israel & PLO exchange mutual recognition in 1993.

## 3. Oslo I &amp; Jordan Treaty

White House handshake; PA established in Gaza-Jericho; Jordan signs formal peace treaty with Israel in Oct 1994.

## 4. Oslo II &amp; Rabin Murder (1995)

West Bank split into Areas A (3%), B (25%), C (72%); Hamas bus bombings; Yigal Amir assassinates Rabin on 4 Nov 1995.

## ★ GCSE SPECIFICATION WORD BANK &amp; ESSENTIAL HISTORICAL CONCEPTS

## 12 KEY TERMS

**GENEVA UN SPEECH (1988)** Arafat explicitly renounced terrorism and recognized Israel, opening US talks.

**JOHAN JØRGEN HOLST** Norwegian Foreign Minister who secretly hosted and mediated the Oslo peace talks.

**ISRAEL-JORDAN TREATY (1994)** Peace treaty signed by King Hussein and Yitzhak Rabin at Wadi Araba in Oct 1994.

**HAMAS SUICIDE BOMBINGS** Campaign of bus bombings in 1994–96 designed to sabotage the Oslo peace process.

**400K EXPELLED FROM GULF** Palestinians expelled from Kuwait/Saudi after Arafat backed Saddam in 1990.

**OSLO I ACCORDS (1993)** Historic declaration of principles signed on White House lawn on 13 Sept 1993.

**OSLO II AGREEMENT (1995)** Agreement dividing the West Bank into administrative Areas A (3%), B (25%), C (72%).

**YIGAL AMIR** Right-wing Orthodox Jewish extremist who assassinated Prime Minister Rabin on 4 Nov 1995.

**600,000 SOVIET IMMIGRANTS** Massive influx of Soviet Jews (1989–95) bolstering Israeli demographics.

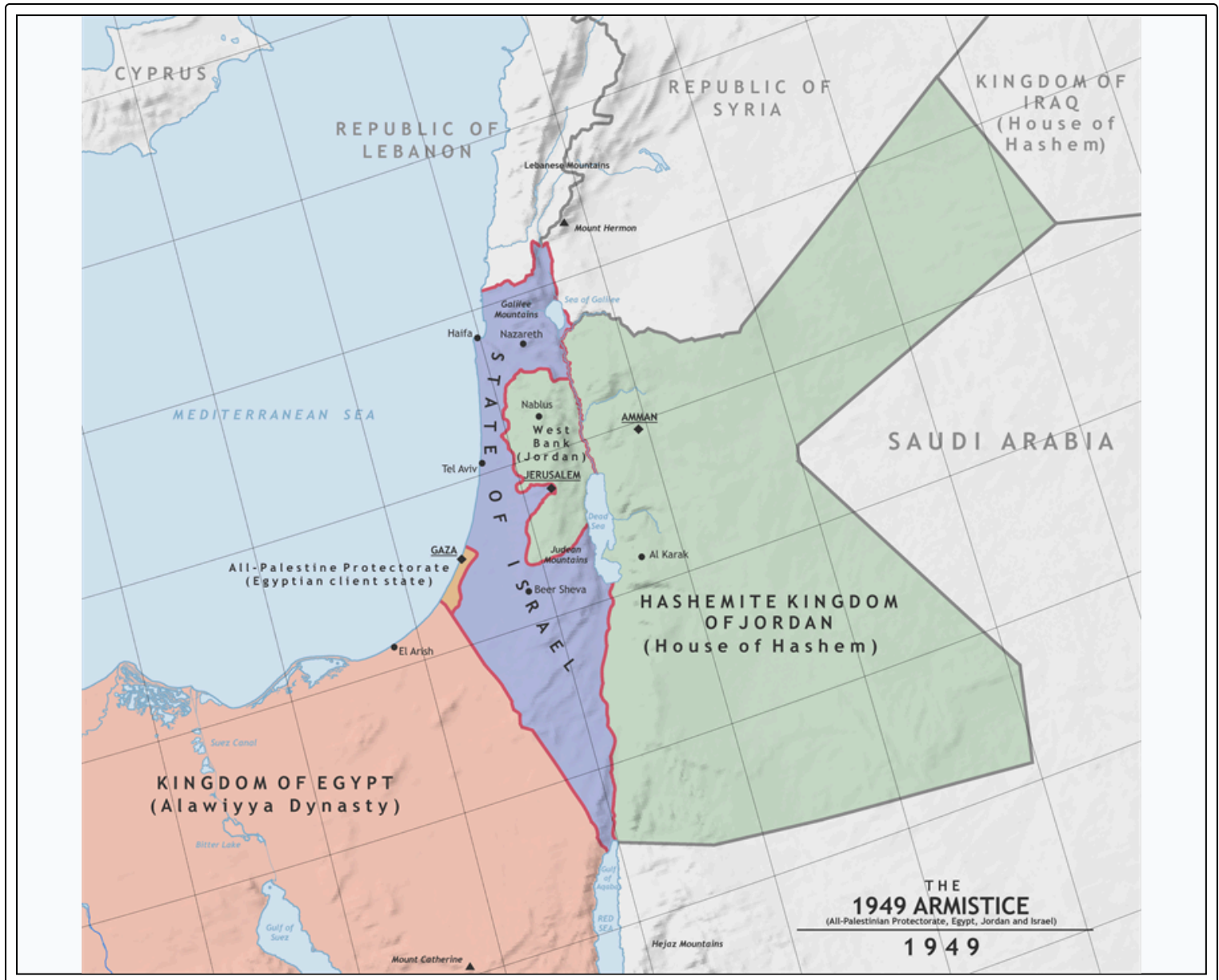
**PALESTINIAN AUTHORITY (PA)** Interim Palestinian self-governing body established in 1994 to rule Gaza and Jericho.

**AREA A, B, C ZONES** Three-tiered territorial division determining Palestinian vs Israeli administrative control.

**YITZHAK RABIN MURDER (1995)** Assassination of Israeli Prime Minister, dealing a fatal blow to the Oslo peace momentum.

# THE 1949 ARMISTICE GREEN LINE & THE PALESTINIAN REFUGEE CRISIS

FACING ATLAS SPREAD • LEFT



## 1. THE 1949 ARMISTICE AGREEMENTS (THE GREEN LINE)

- **Territorial Expansion:** Israel increased from 55% (UN partition) to 79% of mandatory Palestine (+24% territorial gain), establishing the de facto Green Line.
- **Arab Annexations:** Transjordan annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem (renaming as Kingdom of Jordan); Egypt occupied and administered the Gaza Strip.
- **Armistice vs Permanent Peace:** Signed on Rhodes under UN mediator Ralph Bunche; Arab states refused to recognise Israel or sign formal peace treaties.

## 2. THE PALESTINIAN REFUGEE CRISIS (AL-NAKBA)

- **Displacement Scale:** ~700,000–750,000 Palestinian Arabs became refugees, fleeing or expelled from villages into camps in the West Bank, Gaza, Jordan, Syria, and Lebanon.
- **UN Resolution 194 (Dec 1948):** Resolved that refugees wishing to return to their homes and live at peace should be permitted to do so; rejected by Israel.
- **UNRWA Established (1949):** Provided permanent relief, food, and schools, creating enduring camps that fueled future Palestinian resistance (Fedayeen).

# MIDDLE EAST STRATEGIC GEOPOLITICS & MARITIME CHOKEPOINTS

FACING ATLAS SPREAD •  
RIGHT



## 1. THE TWO CRITICAL MARITIME CHOKEPOINTS

- **The Suez Canal:** Connects Mediterranean to Red Sea; vital conduit for European trade and Gulf oil. Nationalised by Nasser (1956); closed during 1967–75 wars.
- **Straits of Tiran:** Narrow waterway at Sharm el-Sheikh controlling access to Israel's southern port of Eilat; Egyptian blockade in 1956 and May 1967 acted as direct *casus belli*.
- **Superpower Geopolitics:** Middle East served as Cold War flashpoint (US support for Israel vs Soviet arms/advisers to Egypt and Syria).

## 2. THE STRATEGIC FRONTLINE STATES

- **The Confrontation States:** Egypt, Syria, and Jordan directly bordered Israel and bore the military burden of the 1948, 1956, 1967, and 1973 wars.
- **The Gulf Oil Weapon (OPEC):** Saudi Arabia and Arab producers leveraged oil embargoes in 1973, quadrupling world oil prices to pressure Western powers.
- **The Diplomatic Shift:** Camp David (1978–79) removed Egypt (the largest Arab military power) from the battlefield, permanently transforming regional strategy.

# MASTER HISTORIOGRAPHICAL DEBATES: TRADITIONAL VS NEW HISTORIANS

GRADE 9  
MASTERY

**Historiographical Overview: The Evolution of Middle Eastern Historical Debate**

High-achieving students distinguish between **Traditional Zionist/Arab historiography** and the critical **"New Historians"** who emerged after Israeli state archives were declassified under the 30-year rule in the late 1980s. Understanding these competing interpretations allows students to provide nuanced, evaluative judgments in Paper 2 Question 3 (Importance).

**DEBATE 1: CAUSES OF THE 1948 PALESTINIAN REFUGEE EXODUS (AL-NAKBA)**

**Traditional Zionist Narrative:** Arab leaders broadcast radio orders urging civilians to flee temporarily to clear the path for invading Arab armies, promising a swift return after victory.

**"New Historian" Critique (Benny Morris):** Declassified IDF documents revealed no broadcast orders; refugees fled due to military assaults, Plan Dalet expulsions, and terror following the Deir Yassin massacre.

**DEBATE 2: RESPONSIBILITY FOR THE 1967 SIX DAY WAR**

**Israeli Pre-emptive Defence View:** Nasser's expulsion of UNEF, closure of the Straits of Tiran (an act of war), and mobilization of 100,000 troops created an existential threat justifying pre-emptive strikes.

**Revisionist / Pan-Arab View:** Nasser was engaged in political brinkmanship without an offensive plan; Israeli military leadership exploited Arab rhetoric to capture the West Bank, Golan Heights, and East Jerusalem.

**DEBATE 3: THE FAILURE OF THE 1993 OSLO PEACE PROCESS**

**Pro-Israeli Perspective:** Arafat and the PNA failed to dismantle terrorist networks ( Hamas and Islamic Jihad suicide bombings), proving the Palestinian leadership was unwilling to guarantee Israeli security.

**Pro-Palestinian Perspective (Edward Said):** Oslo was an instrument of Palestinian capitulation; Israeli settlement expansion doubled in the West Bank while leaving core issues (Jerusalem, refugees, borders) unresolved.

**★ FINAL EXAMINATION READINESS: CORE REVISION MILESTONES**

☐ Master all 12 Word Banks (144 key terms)

☐ Memorize 1948, 1956, 1967, 1973 dates

☐ Distinguish Res 181 (1947) from Res 242 (1967)

☐ Explain 3 impacts of 1979 Washington Treaty

☐ Trace 4-stage Oslo Accords territorial division

☐ Master UN Resolution 242 "Land for Peace" terms